

**COURSE TITLE- HISTORY OF THE EMERGENCE
OF BANGLADESH**

COURSE CODE- BDS-1201

BASIC KNOWLEDGE- (1947-1971)

BY- NABILA SULTANA (NaSa)

PAKISTAN

Pakistan came into being as a Muslim state on 14 August 1947 consequent upon the end of the British colonial rule in India. Due to unique socio-economic and political developments taking place in Indian subcontinent throughout the colonial regime, Muslims of India led by Mohammed Ali Jinnah demanded a separate state for themselves. But the Congress opposed all proposals for partition, and advocated a united India with a strong centre and a fully responsible parliamentary government. From 1940 onwards, the movement for Pakistan began to gather momentum.

The partition of Bengal in 1947 followed the partition of Bengal in 1905. But in this case Bengal was also divided with India. The partition of India in 1947 was mainly due to the **lack of communal harmony, the failure of the Unified Bengal Movement, the lack of sincerity of the British government, the activities of various organizations and businessmen in Calcutta, two nations theory of Jinnah and the selfishness of the leaders of the two major political parties Congress and Muslim League.** For all these reasons, Lord Mountbatten divided Bengal and Punjab along with the partition of India in June 1947. Through the western part of Hindu majority Bengal was annexed to India and the Muslim majority East Bengal was annexed to Pakistan. The partition plan stated that contiguous Muslim-majority districts in the Punjab and Bengal would go to Pakistan. A plebiscite was held in the Sylhet district of Assam, and, as a result, part of the district was transferred to Pakistan.

Just as Mountbatten favored the Congress in the Indian section, so did Radcliffe, chairman of the Boundary Commission, favor the Congress. It created many problems for the Bengali department. Many Muslim-majority areas, including Nadia, Maldah and Murshidabad, came under Hindu-dominated India.

Early difficulties- In August 1947, Pakistan faced with a number of problems, some immediate but others long term. The most important of these concerns was the role played by Islam. Was Pakistan to be a secular state serving as a homeland for Muslims of the subcontinent, or was to be an Islamic state governed by the sharia, in which non-Muslims would be minority citizens Foodgrain The second question concerned the distribution of power between the centre and the provincial governments. Above all other concerns were the violence and the refugee problem. Muslims were fleeing India; Hindus and Sikhs were fleeing Pakistan. About a million Muslims entered East Bengal from various parts of India, particularly from

Bihar and West Bengal. Frequent communal riots flared up in Punjab and East Bengal. Jinnah's plea to regard religion as a personal matter, not a state matter, was ignored. The most conservative estimates of the casualties were 250,000 dead and 12 million to 24 million refugees. The actual boundaries of the two new states were not even known until 17 August, when a commission headed by a British judge announced them. Partition and its accompanying confusion also brought severe economic challenge to the new state. Furthermore, Pakistan faced logistic problems for its commercial transportation. But the problem that proved most intractable was defining relations between the two wings of Pakistan. Constitutional Beginnings' Although Jinnah led the movement for Pakistan as a separate Muslim nation, he was appalled by the communal riots and urged equal rights for all citizens irrespective of religion. Jinnah died in September 1948 only thirteen months after independence leaving his successors to tackle the problems of Pakistan's identity.

- State policy of Pakistan
- Primary problems of Pakistan as a new country

• **INEQUALITY BETWEEN EAST PAKISTAN & WEST PAKISTAN---**

PROMINENT POLITICAL PARTIES

- ☐ Peoples Freedom League (Gono Ajadi League)
- ☐ Pakistan Democratic Jubo League
- ☐ Tamaddun Majlish
- ☐ Others Parties
- ☐ Decline of Muslim League
- ☐ Awami Muslim League
- ☐ Krishak Sramik Party
- ☐ Pakistan National Congress
- ☐ Khilafat-e-Rabbani Party
- ☐ Nizam-e-Islam Party
- ☐ Jamaat-e-Islami

- ❖ All Bengal Student Federation
- ❖ All Bengal Student Congress
- ❖ All Bengal Muslim Student League
- ❖ East Pakistan Muslim Student League; Later, Student League/ Chhatra League

- ✓ Student Federation
- ✓ East Bengal Student Union
- ✓ National Student Federation (N.S.F)

LANGUAGE MOVEMENT (1952):

The language movement is one of the most important events of our Bangladeshi culture. This was the first step towards the growth of Bangladeshi nationalism and for a unique and separate identity as a Bangladeshi.

After the creation of Pakistan, from 1948 to 21 February 1952 the movement in east Pakistan to make Bengali one of the state languages of Pakistan was called Language Movement.

The language movement was divided into two phases.

1. By 1948, the movement was largely confined to the educated and intellectual classes.
2. By 1952, the language movement had spread throughout the Bengali nation.

Background of the Language Movement:

The state of Pakistan was formed on 14 August, 1947 on the basis of biracialism. The two part of Pakistan had no similarity in respect of history, tradition, culture, language. Despite the parts; West Pakistan and East Pakistan (East Bengal) having situated 1000 miles apart, they become one on the basis of only religion. The ruler class from the West Pakistan vested themselves to exploit the East Pakistan in suppressive manner from the very first day of Independence from British Monarchy in August 1947. They had tried to impose Urdu' as the state language; which was only spoken by a minor 3.27% people ignoring the vast majority of 56.40% of its total population speaking Bengali. The rulers from West Pakistan declared Urdu as the state language of Pakistan ignoring the opinion of the majority group. The scholars of Bengal erupted in oppose of the decision. They strongly protested this discriminating decision. In this way, the language movement started to get its momentum. The agitation reached its peak in 1952. The whole country (East Pakistan) followed the demonstration. The first time in the world history; Salam, Barkat, Rafique, Jabbar and many other embraced martyrdoms for the love of their mother tongue. Language movement had sowed the seed of independence within the dream of Bengali Nation. This motivated the long thriving struggle and revolution to give birth of a new country - our beloved Bangladesh.

Reasons Behind the Language Movement:

Irrational decision to make Urdu the State language of Pakistan:

They had tried to impose Urdu' as the state language; which was only spoken by a minor 3.27% people ignoring the vast majority of 56.40% of its total population speaking Bengali. The rulers from West Pakistan declared Urdu as the state language of Pakistan ignoring the opinion of the majority group. They used Urdu in the office, court as an official language.

Development of Bengali nationalism:

In just a few years, Gana-Azadi League, Democratic Juba League, East Pakistan Muslim Chatra League, Awami Muslim League etc. were established. They raised their voice and demanded to make Bengali the state language along with Urdu.

The Emergence of Various Organizations:

Besides, many organizations like Tamuddin Majlis, Rashtrabhasha Sangram Parishad, All-Party Rashtrabhasha Sangram Parishad etc established in that time. Through all these organizations Bengali nationalism developed. As a result, the people of East Pakistan were not willing to give concessions.

Emergence of Intellectual Class:

Many intellectuals like Professor Abul Kashem, Dr. Muhammad Shahidullah, Maulana Akram Khan, Kazi Motahar Hossain has emerged. They came to light and play an important role to the language movement.

Economical Reason:

Although the language movement started as a cultural movement, but there were economic reasons behind this movement. Since the creation of Pakistan, there has been food shortage in East Bengal due to their discriminatory policies. Due to their discriminatory policies, famine occurred in Khulna, Faridpur, Sylhet, Mymensingh and North Bengal in 1948-1949 and 1951. As a result, the revolt of peasants, workers and lower-middle class people later turned into a political demand.

The failure of the rulers to run the state

Torture of Bengalis by the Petwa forces of Pakistan: On 31st August 1947, anonymous Pakistani gangster attacked the students of Fazlul Haque Hall of Dhaka University. As a result, dissatisfaction was created among the students.

Events of Language Movement:

The state of Pakistan was formed on 14 August, 1947 on the basis of biracialism. The two part of Pakistan had no similarity in respect of history, tradition, culture, language. Despite the parts; West Pakistan and East Pakistan (East Bengal) having situated 1000 miles apart, they become one on the basis of only religion. The ruler class from the West Pakistan vested themselves to exploit the East Pakistan in suppressive manner from the very first day of Independence from British Monarchy in August 1947. They had tried to impose Urdu' as the state language; which was only spoken by a minor 3.27% people ignoring the vast majority of 56.40% of its total population speaking Bengali.

First, at the National Education Conference in Karachi in November 1947, the original proposal supported Urdu and English as the only state languages. There was immediate opposition and protest.

Later, Dhirendranath Dutta, a member of the Pakistan Constituent Assembly, first demanded that Bengali be made the official language of Pakistan along with Urdu. However, on March 21, 1947, Muhammad Ali Jinnah, the first Governor-General of Pakistan, declared that Urdu and Urdu would be the only official state languages of Pakistan. The Bengali people opposed this declaration. Students and intellectuals in East Pakistan protested and demanded that not only Urdu but also Bengali should be one of the state languages. In 1947, the language movement started in this province known as East Pakistan.

A general strike was held on March 11, 1948, in which students of language universities and other colleges in the city protested against the exclusion of Bengali language from official use. Political leaders including Shamsul Haque, Shawkat Ali, M Sirajul Islam, Kazi Golam Mahbub, Oli Ahad and Abdul Wahed were arrested during the rally. A meeting was held on the afternoon of March 11 to protest the police brutality and arrests. Then a gathering of students proceeded towards the Secretariat building. Several students and leaders, including AK Fazlul Haque, who were in the procession at the time, were attacked and injured by police. Due to civil unrest, the Governor General of Pakistan Muhammad Ali Jinnah arrived in Dhaka on 19 March 1948. He again declared that "Urdu, and Urdu only" embodied the consciousness of the Muslim nation and would remain the state language. On March

24, he made the same statement at Curzon Hall of Dhaka University. Both meetings were interrupted by a large section of the audience. The students formed the 'State Language Action Committee' and worked tirelessly to make Bengali one of the state languages of Pakistan. Immediately after the tragedy of February 21, 1952, the then Prime Minister of Pakistan Khwaja Nazimuddin announced in a public meeting that Urdu should be made the state language of Pakistan. The students were outraged by the announcement because in 1948, Nazimuddin, as the Chief Minister of East Bengal, had signed a pledge with the leaders of the State Language Action Committee by the Provincial Council to adopt Bengali as another state language of Pakistan. Subsequently, the students of Dhaka University and Dhaka Medical College took a strong stand for the language movement and took an important decision and on February 21, 1952 denied the will of the politicians to violate Section 144. At 3:30 pm on the orders of the Police Magistrate (West Pakistani) opened fire on a peaceful procession of students. Barkat, Rafiq, Jabbar, Shafiur and Salam, among others, dedicated their precious young lives to the preservation and preservation of their mother tongue, Bengali. This movement finally ended in 1956 with the adoption of Bengali as one of the state languages of Pakistan.

February 21st is a symbol of mourning, strength and pride in the life of every Bengali. International Mother Language Day is celebrated as Martyr's Day in Bangladesh because we have added a symbolic value to this day. It nurtured ideas of democracy and secularism. It has been celebrated all over Bangladesh, and across the borders of Bangladesh as a great national event.

Importance/Significance:

Language Movement began in 1948 and reached its climax in the killing of 21 February 1952, and ended in the adoption of Bangla as one of the state languages of Pakistan.

In the cultural field:

The language movement has not only enriched the Bengali culture but also the culture of the whole world. Every year 21st February is celebrated all over the world as the International Mother Language Day. We have struggled to acquire this language. '21 February' has been declared as 'International Mother Language Day' on 17 November, 1999 in the general assembly of UNESCO in Paris. Since 2000,

this day has been observed in the international arena with proper honor and manifesto. Today, as a nation, we are proud that the highest sacrifices of Bangladesh, Bengali and our language movement are recognized, much admired, remembered with gratitude and honored worldwide.

The beginning of a new horizon in Bengali literature:

Numerous plays, novels, films, poems and songs have been written about the language movement. As a result, a new horizon in Bengali literature was started through language movement.

Creation of new occasions in Bengali culture:

This movement has given a new definition to Bengali culture through the development and inauguration of Bengali language, literature and culture. Language is not only the main representative of the culture of a nation, it creates patriotism and nationalism in the minds of the people. Martyr's Day is celebrated on 21st February on the occasion of language movement. Besides, 21st February was declared a public holiday, a month-long Ekushey Book Fair was organized and "Ekushey Padak" was given to those who sacrificed their lives in the language movement.

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Development of Bengali nationalism:

In just a few years, Gana-Azadi League, Democratic Juba League, East Pakistan Muslim Chatra League, Awami Muslim League etc. were established. They raised their voice and demanded to make Bengali the state language along with Urdu.

The Emergence of Various Organizations:

Besides, many organizations like Tamuddin Majlis, Rashtrabhasha Sangram Parishad, All-Party Rashtrabhasha Sangram Parishad etc established in that time. Through all these organizations Bengali nationalism developed. As a result, the people of East Pakistan were not willing to give concessions.

The Emergence of Political Consciousness-

The Shahid Minar became the center of Bengali emotion. The status of Bengali language increased.

Non-communal consciousness develops from 1948 to 1952, the crisis in East Bengal was much less recent than before.

How to Create Bengali Nationalism:

Pakistani government had tried to impose Urdu' as the state language; which was only spoken by a minor 3.27% people ignoring the vast majority of 56.40% of its total population speaking Bengali. The rulers from West Pakistan declared Urdu as the state language of Pakistan ignoring the opinion of the majority group. They used Urdu in the office, court as a official language. Along with Dhirendranath Datta , all the people of east Pakistan raised their voice against it.

Tamaddun Majlish, is an Islamic cultural organization in Bangladesh, established in 1947 by Principal Abul Kashem in the former East Pakistan. It was one of the founding organizations of the Bengali Language Movement. On 15 September 1947, Tamaddun Majlish published a pamphlet entitled "Bangla or Urdu, the State Language of Pakistan". Through this booklet, Professor Abul Kashem, Kazi Motahar Hossain and Abul Mansur Ahmed demanded to make Bengali the state language along with Urdu.

In just a few years, Gana-Azadi League, Democratic Juba League, East Pakistan Muslim Chatra League, Awami Muslim League etc. were established. They raised their voice and demanded to make Bengali the state language along with Urdu.

Besides, many organizations like Rashtrabhasha Sangram Parishad, AllParty Rashtrabhasha Sangram Parishad etc established in that time. Through all these organizations Bengali nationalism developed. As a result, the people of East Pakistan were not willing to give concessions.

Students, teachers, peasants, workers, men and women from all started a movement to make Bengali the state language.

Thus, when the Pakistani ruling class decided to make Urdu as the state language, all classes of people including East Pakistan politicians, intellectuals, students, teachers, farmers, workers, men and women protested through meetings, strikes and

rallies under the leadership of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, which created Bengali nationalism.

UNITED FRONT COALITION AND ELECTION OF 1954:

United Front

The United Front is a coalition formed by several opposition parties to contest the 1954 elections against the Muslim League. On 4 December 1953, the Krishak-Praja Party led by Sher-e-Bangla AK Fazlul Huq, the Awami Muslim League led by Maulana Abdul Hamid Khan Bhasani, the Nezame Islami led by Maulana Atahar Ali and the Left Democratic Party led by Haji Danesh formed the United Front.

Background of the United Front:

Muslim League was the oldest and largest party among the political parties in Bengal before the election of 1954. Besides, Muslim League was leading the provincial government of east Bengal. As a result, the newly formed parties in the east Pakistan planned to form coalition as a strategy to defeat Muslim League in the election in 1954. Resultantly, the decision to form United Front Coalition was taken at the council of Awami Muslim League in Mymensing on 14th November, 1953. The coalition consisted of four main opposition parties; Awami Muslim League led by Maulana Abdul Hamid Khan Bhashani, Krishak-Praja Party led by A K Fazlul Haque, Nezam-E-Islami of Maulana Atahar Ali and the leftist Democratic Party of Hazi Danesh. The electoral symbol for the United Front Coalition was 'Boat'. The coalition declared 21-point charter of election manifesto by selecting the main demands made on the 42 point election manifesto of Awami Muslim League. Abul Mansur Ahmed was the main person to write the 21-point charter with the view to reflect the hopes and expectations from the mass people of East Bengal.

21-Points Charter of United Front:

1. To Establish Bengali as one of the state language of Pakistan
2. To dissolve the Zamindari System without compensation and distribute the surplus land among the landless people
3. To nationalize the Jute Industry.
4. To establish co-operative agricultural system to develop agriculture.
5. To set up salt factory

6. To generate employment for the mohazer-artist-technician class.
7. To eradicate flood and famine through digging canal and arranging irrigation. Language Movements and Afterwards Political Episode 139
8. To make the country self-dependent on food and industry
9. To introduce free and mandatory primary education.
10. Education through mother language, reduce the gap between government and private schools and providing government assistance favoring every school.
11. To convert the University of Dhaka and Rajshahi University as autonomous body.
12. To reduce the administrative expenses. Ministers salary no to be more than Taka one thousand.
13. To take necessary steps to control bribery, corruption and nepotism.
14. To cancel the dark laws including Public Protection Act and Ordinance.
15. To separate the Judicial Department from the Administrative Department.
16. To make the chief minister's residence 'the Bardhawan House' as Bengali Language Research Center.
17. To construct a monument commemorating the martyrs of 52's language movement.
18. To declare 21 February as government holiday considering it as Shahid Dibosh.
19. To provide full autonomy to East Bengal as per 1940-Lahore Resolution.
20. In no way the validity of Legislative Assembly is extended.
21. If any seats in the Legislative Assembly become vacant, it should be filled in within three months by giving by-election.

Results of the Election of 1954:

Election Victory:

The United Front (Awami Muslim League 143, Krishak-Praja Party 48, Nezame Islami 19, Left Democratic Party 13) won 223 out of 237 Muslim seats in the

provincial assembly elections and the Muslim League won only 10 seats. Besides, out of 72 non-Muslim seats, United Front got 13 seats.

Formation of government:

The United Front Cabinet was formed on 3 April 1954 under the leadership of Sher-e-Bangla AK Fazlul Huq. On 15 May 1954, the Awami Muslim League joined the cabinet and Sheikh Mujibur Rahman was appointed Minister of Agriculture, Cooperatives and Rural Development.



The United Front Cabinet

Dissolution of United Front government

However, within weeks of assuming power, the newly elected provincial legislature was dismissed by Governor-General Ghulam Muhammad, upon accusations against A K Fazlul Huq of attempting secession. The central government of Pakistan was alarmed at the United Front's victory and while it instituted Governor General's rule in East Pakistan, the central government instituted the One Unit plan in West Pakistan, where they amalgamated all of Pakistan's provinces into one giant province called West Pakistan to try to prevent the smaller provinces from coordinating with East Bengal to offset Punjab's overwhelming power in the military and civil government of Pakistan. The One Unit scheme was essentially an anti-democratic provocation meant to stop East Bengal from taking advantage of its numerical superiority. It also alienated the smaller provinces of West Pakistan by robbing the Sindhis, Baluchis and Pashtuns of their provincial identities. The overthrow of the

United Front government and the creation of the One Unit of West Pakistan alienated the Bengalis and caused them to demand maximum autonomy or even to secede from Pakistan.

The dismissal of the United Front was a key turning point in aggravating East Pakistan's grievances in the Pakistani union, and led Maulana Bhashani to openly call for separation and independence in 1957, in his Salaam, Pakistan (Farewell, Pakistan) speech.

Importance and Significance of the election of 1954: (learn in detail)

1. Bengali nationalism is strong.
2. A united public opinion was formed.
3. The influence of the middle class increases.
4. Political awareness increases in East Pakistan.
5. The boat gained recognition as a symbol of election.
6. Non-communal politics developed.
7. It inspired the war of independence.

Reasons for the defeat of the Muslim League (explain broadly)

1. Formation of United Front and widespread support in East Pakistan
2. Failure to formulate the constitution of the Muslim League
3. Lack of competent leadership
4. Mass isolation of the Muslim League
5. Conflict of the Muslim League
6. Boundless inequality between East and West Pakistan
7. Boundless corruption and nepotism

For more information about United Front:

https://en.banglapedia.org/index.php/United_Front

[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/United_Front_\(East_Pakistan\)#:~:text=Fazlul%20Huq%20of%20the%20Krishak,Ahmed%20becoming%20key%20federal%20ministers](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/United_Front_(East_Pakistan)#:~:text=Fazlul%20Huq%20of%20the%20Krishak,Ahmed%20becoming%20key%20federal%20ministers)

The Constitution of Pakistan in 1956:

Constitution is the supreme law of a country. The administration of a country is run by its constitution. Constituent Assembly was formed by the public representatives elected in 1946. The assembly was Language Movements and Afterwards Political Episode 141 responsible to act as the new parliament and write the constitution of Pakistan. But, the task of the assembly used to be disrupted by the disinclination of the ruling bodies. At last, to write the constitution of Pakistan; the constituent assembly formed a Committee of Basic Principle was formed on March 1949. On the various suggestions in the report the people of East Bengal were deprived in all aspects. As a result, when the report was published in September 1950, it caused huge protest in East Bengal and they denied the suggestions made by the report. Afterwards, the committee submitted its second report in 1952 and the third report in 1953. But, the adoption of the constitution remained unresolved. At last, the Governor General of Pakistan took the responsibility to draft the constitution for the country. The leaders from both of the dominion were able to reach an accord in this regard. On the basis of this the constitution was written on 1956. After adoption, the constitution was active for only two years. In 1958, when Ayub Khan clamped Martial Law in the country the constitution was declared unworkable and with this the constitutional rule came to an end in Pakistan. The first constitution was introduced in Pakistan on 23 March 1956. After nine years of efforts, Pakistan was successful in framing a constitution. The Constituent Assembly adopted it on 29 February 1956.

AYUB REGIME

Khan, Field Marshal Mohammad Ayub (1908-1974) military ruler and President of Pakistan. Ayub Khan was born at Abbottabad in the Northwest Frontier Province in 1908. He was educated at Aligarh Muslim University and at Royal Military College, Sandhurst, UK. He joined the army in 1928. He was promoted to the rank of Major General in December 1948 and was then appointed the General Officer Commanding (GOC) in the province of East Bengal. He discharged the responsibility of Defence Minister of Pakistan between 1954 and 1956.

In collusion with the then President Iskandar Mirza, army chief Ayub Khan imposed martial law in Pakistan on 7 October 1958, and abrogated the Constitution. Ayub Khan was appointed the Chief Martial Law Administrator by President Mirza on 8 October. But only after a few days, he ousted Iskandar Mirza from power (27 October) and declared himself the President of Pakistan.

Ayub Khan's martial law regime was a form of representational dictatorship, and he introduced a new political system in 1959 as basic democracies. The Basic Democracies system set up four tiers of institutions. The lowest tier was composed of union councils and the members were designated as basic democrats.

Basic Democracies

Basic Democracies a local government system introduced during the Ayub regime in the early 1960s. General Ayub Khan, President of Pakistan, introduced the concept of basic democracy under the Basic Democracies Order, 1959 having made an attempt to initiate a grass-root level democratic system. Of course, most of the political parties of East Pakistan had different ideas about his scheme, and considered it a bid to usurp power in the hands of Ayub Khan and other vested groups.

The system of Basic Democracies was initially a five-tier arrangement. They were: (i) union councils (rural areas), town and union committees (urban areas); (ii) thana councils (East Pakistan), tehsil councils (West Pakistan); (iii) district councils; (iv) divisional councils.

Union Councils:

At the base of the system was the union council which consisted of a chairman and usually about 15 members. It had both elected and nominated members. Two-thirds of the members were elected representatives and one-third consisted of non-official

members nominated by the government. However, the nomination was abolished by an amendment in 1962. The members of the council were elected by the people from their respective unions on the basis of universal adult franchise. The chairman of the council was elected by the members from amongst themselves. In a way, it was at par with the erstwhile union board with minor differences. The elected representatives of the union council were called basic democrats. The total number of such councils was 7300.

Thana Council:

In the second tier was the thana council which consisted of ex-officio representative members, official and non-official members. The representative members were the chairmen of the union councils and town committees. The official members were the representatives of various nation-building departments of a thana and their number was fixed by the district magistrate of the concerned district. The total number of official members could not in any case exceed the number of non-official members. The council was headed by the Sub-Divisional Officer (SDO) who was the ex-officio chairman. In his absence the Circle Officer (development) would preside over the meetings of the thana council as ex-officio member. In case of West Pakistan, the thana was known as tehsil and it was presided over by a tehsilder. In all, there were 655 thanas and tehsils in Pakistan.

District Council:

The third tier was the district council. It consisted of one chairman, official and non-official members. The number of members would not exceed 40. The chairmen of thana councils were its members, and other official members were drawn from district level officers of development departments and an equal number of non-official members. At least 50% the non-official members were drawn from amongst the chairmen of union councils and town committees. The district magistrate acted as chairman of the council while the vice-chairman was elected by the elected members of the council.

In absence of the chairman the vice-chairman had to perform such other functions assigned by the chairman. There were 74 district councils in Pakistan. The district council was the most important tier in the basic democracy system. It was the successor organization to the district board. So far as the composition of the council was concerned, it regressed beyond its 1885 position when 25% members were nominated.

Divisional Council:

The fourth and the apex tier was the divisional council. The Divisional Commissioner was the ex-officio chairman of the council. It had both official and non-official (representative) members. The maximum number of members was 45. Official members consisted of the chairmen of district councils of the concerned division and representatives of development departments. The total number of divisional councils was sixteen.

Basic democracies specified a provincial development advisory council for each wing. Its composition followed the pattern of the divisional council except that only one-third of the appointed members had to be selected from union council chairmen. The council did not have any power. However, it was dropped with the introduction of provincial assemblies in both East and West Pakistan.

The urban areas had a similar arrangement, under which the smaller union councils were grouped together into municipal committees to perform similar duties. In 1960, the elected members of the union councils voted to confirm Ayub Khan's presidency, and under the 1962 Constitution they formed an electoral college to elect the President, the National Assembly, and the provincial assemblies. The system of Basic democracies did not have time to take root or to fulfil Ayub Khan's intentions before he and the system fell in 1969.

By 1958 Ayub Khan and his fellow officers decided to turn out the politicians, a task easily accomplished without bloodshed. He then took some fiscal measure especially in land holding. The landholding ceiling was raised from thirty-three hectares to forty-eight hectares. Landholders retained their dominant positions in the social hierarchy. Some 4 million hectares of land in West Pakistan, much of it in Sindh, was released for public acquisition between 1959 and 1969 and sold mainly to civil and military officers, thus creating a new class of farmers having medium-sized holdings. These farms became immensely important for future agricultural development, but the peasants were scarcely benefited.

In 1958, a legal commission was set up to suggest reforms of the family and marriage laws. Ayub Khan examined its report and in 1961 issued the Family Laws Ordinance. Among other things, it restricted polygamy and 'regulated' marriage and divorce, giving women more equal treatment under the law than they had before. It was a humane measure supported by women's organisations in Pakistan. However,

this law which was similar to the one passed on family planning, was relatively mild and did not seriously transform the patriarchal pattern of society.

Ayub Khan adopted an energetic approach toward economic development that soon bore fruit in a rising rate of economic growth. Land reform, consolidation of holdings, and stern measures against hoarding were combined with rural credit programmes and work programmes, higher procurement prices, augmented allocations for agriculture, and, especially improved seeds to put the country on the road to self-sufficiency in food grains in the process described as the Green Revolution. The Export Bonus Vouchers Scheme (1959) and tax incentives stimulated new industrial entrepreneurs and exporters. Bonus vouchers facilitated access to foreign exchange for imports of industrial machinery and raw materials. Tax concessions were offered for investment in less-developed areas. These measures had important consequences in the development of industry and gave rise to a new class of small industrialists.

On 1 March 1962, Ayub Khan introduced a Constitution based on the presidential system and thereby became all-powerful in the country. In November 1964, election of basic democrats was held in both the wings of Pakistan. On 2 January 1965, election for the presidency of Pakistan was held through an indirect system of voting. The 80,000 basic democrats elected earlier had to act as the electoral college in this election. Ayub Khan was elected President by defeating the opposition candidate Fatema Jinnah.

Ayub Khan articulated his foreign policy on several occasions, particularly in his autobiography, *Friends not Masters*. His objectives were the security and development of Pakistan and the preservation of its ideology as he saw it. Toward these ends, he sought to improve or normalise relations with Pakistan's immediate and looming neighbours, India, China, and the Soviet Union. While retaining and renewing the alliance with the United States, Ayub Khan emphasised his preference for friendship, not subordination, and bargained hard for higher returns to Pakistan.

Other than ideology and Kashmir, the main source of friction between Pakistan and India was the distribution of the waters of the Indus River system. A compromise that appeared to meet the needs of both countries was reached during the 1950s; it was not until 1960 that a solution finally found favour with Ayub Khan and Jawaharlal Nehru. Broadly speaking, the agreement allocated use of the three western Indus rivers (the Indus itself and its tributaries, the Jhelum and the Chenab) to Pakistan, and the three eastern Indus tributaries (the Ravi, Beas, and Sutlej) to

India. The agreement also detailed transitional arrangements, new irrigation and hydroelectric power works, and the waterlogging and salinity problems in Pakistan. The Indus Basin Development Fund was established and financed by the World Bank.

Pakistan's tentative approaches to China intensified in 1959 when China's occupation of Tibet and the flight of Dalai Lama to India ended five years of Chinese-Indian friendship. An entente between Pakistan and China evolved in inverse ratio to Sino-Indian hostility, which climaxed in a border war in 1962. This informal alliance became a keystone of Pakistan's foreign policy and grew to include a border agreement in March 1963, highway construction connecting the two countries at the Karakoram Pass, agreements on trade, and Chinese economic assistance and grants of military equipment, which was later thought to have included exchanges in nuclear technology. China's diplomatic support and transfer of military equipment was important to Pakistan during the 1965 Indo-Pakistan War over Kashmir. The Soviet Union strongly disapproved of Pakistan's alliance with the United States, but Moscow was interested in keeping doors open to both Pakistan and India. Ayub Khan was able to secure Soviet neutrality during the 1965 Indo-Pakistan war.

Ayub Khan was the architect of Pakistan's policy of close alignment with the United States, and his first major foreign policy act was to sign bilateral economic and military agreements with the United States in 1959. Nevertheless, Ayub Khan expected more from these agreements than the United States was willing to offer and thus remained critical of the role the United States played in South Asia. Especially troublesome to Pakistan was United States' neutrality during the 1965 Indo-Pakistan war. Pakistan did not extend the ten-year agreement signed in 1959.

The 1965 war began as a series of border flare-ups along undemarcated territory at the Rann of Kutch in the southeast in April and soon after along the cease-fire line in Kashmir. The Rann of Kutch conflict was resolved by mutual consent and British sponsorship and arbitration, but the Kashmir conflict proved more dangerous and widespread. Each country had limited objectives, and neither was economically capable of sustaining a long war because military supplies were cut to both countries by the United States and Britain. On September 23, a cease-fire was arranged through the UN Security Council. In January 1966, Ayub Khan and India's prime minister, Lal Bahadur Shastri, signed the Tashkent Declaration which formally ended hostilities and called for a mutual withdrawal of forces.

When war broke out between Pakistan and India on 6 September 1965, Ayub Khan promoted himself to the rank of Field Marshal. Then in 1966, he chose the path of repression of his political opponents when the Six-point demand for autonomy of East Pakistan was raised by the Awami League. The leaders of the Awami League including party chief Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman were arrested. In the backdrop of an intense anti-Ayub movement during the period of 1966-68, Ayub Khan convened a round table conference of opposition political leaders at Rawalpindi on 26 February 1969. But when the conference failed to resolve the crisis, Ayub Khan handed over power to the army chief General Agha Mohammad Yahya Khan on 24 March 1969, and retired from politics. He died on 20 April 1974.

SIX POINT MOVEMENT:

The six-point movement was a Nationalist movement in the East Pakistan, spearheaded by Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, which called for greater autonomy for East Pakistan. It is considered a milestone on the road to the history of the independence of Bangladesh.

Background / Reasons Behind the Six Point Movement

The main reason for proposing this six point programme was to end Master-slave rule in Pakistan. To get rid of the colonial rule and exploitation of Pakistanis, Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman announced the six points program in 1966. The purpose of Bangabandhu was to free East Pakistan from the discrimination through realising six points demand. Basically after the end the war between India and Pakistan, Bangabandhu raised voice against the extreme negligence of the West Pakistan Government to the security of East Pakistan and limitless disparity toward East Pakistan in political, economic, administrative, military, educational affairs as well. Bangabandhu presented the 'six-points' demand (titled '**amader bacher dabi: chhoy dafa karmashuchi**') on 5-6 February in 1966 when Opposition leaders convened a conference in Lahore.

Cultural-

The first attack was on the language. Language, literature and culture of the two wings of Pakistan were quite different. East Pakistan had 56% of the total population. Urdu speaking people were only 3.27%. But the West Pakistan tried to impose Urdu as the state language of Pakistan. They hatred Bengali culture and pointed it as “anti-Islamic” and banned Rabindranath Tagor’s songs in national broadcasting centers.

Economic-

East Pakistan suffered from the highest disparity caused by the West Pakistan in economic affairs. The degree of exploitation by the West Pakistan was terrible. As a result, East Pakistan could never be economically self-sufficient. Head-offices of banks, insurance and commercial organizations including The Central Bank were in West Pakistan. For this money was laundered to West Pakistan very easily. In the first one the government outlay from budget allocations in East and West Pakistan was 113 crore and 500 crore respectively. In the second one the budget allocations were 950 crore for East Pakistan and 1350 crore for West Pakistan. At that time the

rate of total government expenditure in East Pakistan was only 5.10%. 300 crore taka was spent for constructing Islamabad till 1967; whereas, the money spent for Dhaka was 25 crore taka. In the matter of allocating foreign aids East Pakistan got only 26.6% during the period of 1947-1970.

Administrative-

The officials of the civil service were the key force in the Pakistani administration. In 1962 there were only 119 Bangalees among 954 high ranking officials in the Ministries. In the central government offices there were 42000 employees, among them only 2900 were Bangalees. As the capital was set up in Karachi in 1947, the West Pakistanis got employment in a large scale in all government offices.

In East and West Pakistan number of gazetted officials was 1338 and 3708 respectively; and the number of non-gazetted officials was 26310 and 82944 respectively. In the Foreign Service in 1962 there was only 20.8% representation of East Pakistan. In embassies in the foreign countries there were 60 ambassadors from West Pakistan out of 69.

Political-

Although the state of Pakistan was born on the basis of the historic Lahore resolution, East Pakistan was never given the right to autonomy based on the Lahore resolution. Although the United Front won the elections in 1954, it was not allowed to form a representative government. Besides, in 1958, Ayub Khan imposed martial law and deprived the politicians of East Pakistan of their basic rights.

In 1965, August-September, India-Pakistan fought the war over the border issue of Kashmir for 17 days. But in those 17 days East Pakistan was totally unsafe because India could attack anytime and there was no Military force in the East Pakistan. When Bengalis questioned for their safety to Pakistan, they replied "Defense of East Pakistan lies in the hand of West Pakistan." But West Pakistan did not do anything. Bengalis couldn't tolerate this discrimination much longer. They started protesting. From this, a conference was held in Lahore in 5-6 February, in 1966. Sheikh Mujibur Rahman presented the six-point in that conference. "He demand for "absolute autonomy" based on his six-point formula seems to have shaken the foundation of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan.

Military-

Discrimination in the Army, Navy, & Air Force Punjabis had been occupying the top post. In 1955, among 2211 army officers Bangalees were only 82. In 1966, among 17 top ranking officials, there was only one Bangalee . Among 5 lakhs soldiers, Bangalees were only 20000.

Six Points:

The six points are noted as being-

1. The constitution should provide for a Federation of Pakistan in its true sense on the basis of Lahore Resolution and the parliamentary form of government with supremacy of a Legislature directly elected on the basis of universal adult franchise.
2. The federal government should deal with only two subjects: Defense and Foreign Affairs, and all other residuary subjects shall be vested in the federating states.
3. Two separate, but freely convertible currencies for two wings should be introduced; or if this is not feasible, there should be one currency for the whole country, but effective constitutional provisions should be introduced to stop the flight of capital from East to West Pakistan. Furthermore, a separate Banking Reserve should be established and separate fiscal and monetary policy be adopted for East Pakistan.
4. The power of taxation and revenue collection shall be vested in the federating units. The federation will be entitled to deposit a certain portion in the federal fund. The federal government shall use this fund to meet its expenditures.
5. The federal units shall have the full authority to regulate foreign exchange earnings and trade links. There should be two separate accounts for the foreign exchange earnings of the two wings; the foreign exchange requirements of the federal government should be met by the two wings equally or in a ratio to be fixed.
6. To safeguard regional solidarity and national security the provinces should have the authority to form and control their own militia or paramilitary force.

Reaction of Six-point:

1. The government rejected the six points. They referred to Sheikh Mujib as a separatist and Sheikh Mujib was arrested.
2. Ayub Khan described the six points as a conspiracy to form a Hindu-dominated United Bengal.

3. Political parties (Muslim League, Jamaat-e-Islami, Nezami Islami, NAP (Bhasani) rejected the six points.
4. A part of the Awami League, including Maulana Abdur Rashid Tarkabagish, opposed the six points.

Importance/Significance of Six Point programme/ Movement:

The importance of the six-point movement is immense. The six-point movement was the precursor of some momentous events which were the triggering factors of the emergence of Bangladesh.

➤ Demand for Autonomy:

Six-point demand was first identified East Bengal as a separate region and demanded greater autonomy.

➤ Creation of Bengali Nationalism:

Creation of Bengali Nationalism: The six points were a symbol of hope and aspiration of Bengalis. This was the key to the characterization and self-reliance of the Bengali nation consisting of Hindus, Muslims, Christians and Buddhists in East Pakistan. As a result, the six-point movement was severely suppressed and the consciousness of the Bengali nation united them.

➤ Strong voice against exploitation:

The six-point demand was the first strong protest against the long-running exploitation of East Pakistan by the Pakistani government. Sheikh Mujibur Rahman himself referred to the six points as "the Charter of Liberation of Bengal's peasants, workers, laborers, middle class and the common people to step towards the establishment of Bengal's rights".

➤ Six points awaken democratic values.

➤ Six point played an important role in the Agartala Conspiracy Case in 1968 The removal of Ayub Khan's dictatorship.

➤ Six point played an important role in the mass uprising of 1969.

➤ The Election of 1970:

The key factor in Awami League's election manifesto in 1970 was this six points program. The Awami League sought public mandate in favor of the six points program in the general elections of 1970. A landslide victory was gained with the absolute mandate from the people of East Pakistan in favor of six-point program.

➤ The Seeds of Freedom:

The seeds of Bangladesh's independence were sown in the six points. Because the first demand for autonomy was in the six points which helped the mass uprising in 1969 and the victory of Awami League in the election of 1970 which played an important role in the rise of independent Bangladesh.

AGARTALA CONSPIRACY

The Agartala Conspiracy Case was a sedition case in Pakistan during the rule of Ayub Khan against Awami League, brought by the government of Pakistan in 1968 against Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, the leader of the Awami League and East Pakistan, and 34 other people.

In 1963 Bangabandhu visited Tripura secretly. In Agartala - the capital of Tripura - he met Shachindralal Singha, the then Congress leader who became the Chief Minister of Tripura later. In that meeting, Bangabandhu sent a message to the Indian Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru seeking his support for the armed movement through Shachindralal Singha. But the matter was uncovered by Inter-Services Intelligence of Pakistani government. 1500 Bangalees were arrested in Pakistan. Bangabandhu was implicated as the main accused of this conspiracy. Bangabandhu was in jail then. A case was filed in January 1968. The Government framed the charged saying Bangabandhu led a secret meeting with Indian government officials in Agartala, the capital of Indian State Tripura. In the meeting a plan was designed to liberate East Pakistan through armed movement with the assistance from the Government of India. This is why it became known as Agartala Case. But officially the case was termed “the State vs. Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and others”.

The case is officially called State vs. Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and others, but are popularly known as Agartala Shorojontro Mamla (Agartala conspiracy case) as the main conspiracy was purported to have taken place in the Indian city of Agartala in Tripura state, where Sheikh Mujib's associates met Indian military officials.

Background of the Agartala Conspiracy:

Since the creation of Pakistan, there has been a huge disparity between East and West Pakistan. The people of East Pakistan have raised their demands against the West Pakistan.

Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman announced the six points program in 1966. The main reason for proposing the six point programme was to end Master-slave rule in Pakistan. To get rid of the colonial rule and exploitation of Pakistanis.

When Sheikh Mujibur Rahman demanded the six-point, Ayub Khan became very upset. So he called Sheikh Mujib as a separatist and rejected the six-point demand. On the other hand, under the leadership of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, a strong mass movement was formed in East Pakistan demanding autonomy. Later, the

government engaged in various conspiracies to thwart this movement and the Agartala conspiracy case was its practical implementation. On January 18, 1968, Sheikh Mujib was made the number one accused and a case was filed against a total of 35 people.

The Pakistan Govt.during the period 1967-68, announced the names of the following persons who were accused of a military coup in order to free the eastern wing of Pakistan with the help of India.

1. Sheikh Mujibur Rahman
2. Commander Moazzem Hussain,
3. Manik Chiudhury,
4. Bidhankrishna Sen,
5. Dr.Saidur Rahman,
6. Lft.Commander Rauf
7. Ahmed Fazlur Rahman,
8. Ruhul Quddus.
9. Mujibur Rahman,
10. Kamaluddin Ahmed,
- 11.Sultanuddin Ahmed.
12. Mirza M.Ramiz,
13. Amir Hossain
14. A.B.M.A.Samad
15. Khurshid Alam,
16. Mahmud Ali
17. A.B.M.Yusuf
18. Tazul Islam
19. Khurshid Mia
20. Dalil Uddin

21. Masud R.Choudhury
22. Anwar Hossain
23. Matiur Rahman,
24. Captain Khurshid Uddin,
25. Subedar Abdur Razzak,
26. Sergeant A.M.F.Huq,
27. Sergeant Shamsuddin,
28. Havildar Insaf Ali,
29. Khan Shamsur Rahman,
30. Capt. Shaukat Ali,
31. Maj.Nurul Islam
32. Captain Sadekur Rahman Choudhury,
33. Captain Shahabuddin
34. Lft. Colonel Shamsul Alam,
35. Lft. Colonel Mustafizur Rahman

Reaction of Agartala Conspiracy:

Anti-Ayub agitation was getting momentum in both the wings of Pakistan during the trial. In East Pakistan people's voice became stronger to realize the demand for the release of Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and the withdrawal of the case. Gradually the mass movement in East Pakistan turned to mass upsurge in 1969. Some political parties including Awami League, National Awami Party formed a Democratic Action Committee (DAC). At a point of turmoil, Sergeant Zahurul Haq, one of the vital accused in the case, was shot to death in Dhaka Cantonment on 15 February 1969. The news of his death led a furious mob in Dhaka on 16 February 1969.

Strikes, processions, meetings and rallies were held all over the country. On 17 February 1969, Maulana Bhasani made an announcement at Paltan Maidan. He said, "Mujib is better than my three children. If anything happens to Mujib Mia, say Pakistan, or whatever you say, there will be nothing."

At last in the face of the mass movement, the Ayub government was ultimately compelled to withdraw the Agartala Conspiracy Case. All the accused including Sheikh Mujibur Rahman were released on 22 February 1969. On the occasion of the release of Bangabandhu grand public reception rally was organized at the Race Course Ground on 23 February 1969. In that mammoth rally Sheikh Mujibur Rahman was vested with the appellation of 'Bangabandhu'.

Impact/Significance of Agartala Case/Conspiracy:

- This case played a vital role to ignite nationalist consciousness among Bangalees.
- The purpose that inspired Ayub Government to lodge the case did not gain any success; rather it acted as a boomerang against Ayub Government.
- Sheikh Mujib became an unrivaled leader.
- The withdrawal of the case exposed the weakness of the Pakistani government.
- In the minds of the Bengalis intense hatred, anger and mistrust were created against the Pak rulers.
- On March 25, 1969, Ayub Khan was forced to step down.
- The direct effect of this case can be seen in the election of 1970. In the 1970 elections, the Awami League won 167 out of 169 seats.

ELEVEN POINTS PROGRAMME

Eleven Points Programme a charter of demand framed as a remedy to acute economic disparity between East and West Pakistan and as a programme for putting an end to the despotic Ayub regime. The Six-points Movement of Awami League under the leadership of Bangabandhu sheikh mujibur rahman initiated in 1966, sustained a temporary pause consequent upon the en-masse arrest of the Awami League leaders including Bangabandhu, institution of agartala conspiracy case in 1968 and repression on the Awami League activists. The situation led to the formation of Pakistan Democratic Movement (PDM) and the Democratic Action Committee (DAC). But when PDM and DAC ultimately failed to intensify the movement against the autocratic Ayub government, the students of Dhaka University organised a united movement in 1968 which soon turned into a mass movement. In October 1968, the East Pakistan Students League and the Menon and

Matia group of East Pakistan Students Union formed a political alliance. These two student organisations jointly formed the 'Chhatra Sangram Parishad' in January 1968 and declared an eleven points charter of demand.

1 (a) To abandon the policy of provincialisation of the financially solvent colleges and to deprovincialise the colleges hitherto provincialised including the Jagannath College.

(b) To establish schools and colleges throughout the province especially in rural areas for ensuring wider scope for spread of education and to give early approval to the schools and colleges established by private initiative. To establish adequate number of engineering colleges, polytechnic, technical and commercial institutes for providing wider scope for technical education.

(c) To open IA, ISc, ICom and BA, BSc, BCom night classes in second shift in colleges of the province and to open MA and MCom classes in night shift in the established colleges.

(d) To reduce 50% of the tuition fee and to increase the number of scholarship and stipend. Award of scholarship and stipend to any student shall not be seized for his participation in student movement.

(e) To pay 50% of the charges of hall, dining hall and canteen of hostels by the government as 'subsidy'.

(f) To solve accommodation problem in halls and hostels.

(g) To arrange for teaching at all levels of education through the medium of mother tongue. To introduce Bangla as the medium of exchange in offices and courts. To arrange for sufficient number of experienced teachers in all the educational institutions. To enhance the salary of the teachers, and to ensure right of expression of their free opinion.

(h) To provide for tuition-fees free and compulsory education upto class viii. To expand the scope for female education.

(i) To establish medical university, and to fulfill the demands of the medical students, such as abolition of automation system, closing of system of admission by nomination, annulment of Medical Council Ordinance, elevation of dental college to full-fledged college, etc. To fulfill all the demands of the nurse-students.

- (j) To abolish automation system in engineering education, annulment of 10% and 75% rule, proper arrangement of central library, and to fulfill all demands of the engineering students including demand for introduction of class gradation in final year.
- (k) To give facilities of 'condensed course' to the polytechnic students and to issue diploma only on the basis of semester examinations having the Board final examination system withdrawn.
- (l) To fulfill immediately all the demands of the students of Textile, Ceramic, Leather technology and Art College. To fulfill ten points demand of the IER, and to fulfill all the demands of the social welfare students, MBA students and of law students. To bifurcate the Commerce Department as separate 'faculty' in all the universities including the Dhaka University.
- (m) To fulfill the legitimate demands of the students of agricultural schools and colleges, and to fulfill all the demands of the agricultural students including the demand for condensed course of agricultural diploma students.
- (n) To arrange for tickets at 50% concession to the students travelling on train, steamer and launch on display of their identity card. Concession is to be made admissible in monthly tickets also. As in West Pakistan, the students should be allowed to travel any where within the town at 10 paisa fare. Concession in fare at the rate of 50% should be allowed in bus journey in remote areas. Adequate number of buses should be arranged for the school and college going female students. The students attending as spectators at any sports and cultural functions arranged by the government or any semi-government concerns, should be entitled to 50% concession in tickets.
- (o) To arrange for surety of job.
- (p) To annul the defamed university ordinances and to ensure full autonomy to the educational institutions including the universities.
- (q) To reject the National Education Commission Report and the Hamoodur Rahman Commission Report, representing an authentic document of astringent education policy of the ruling class, and to introduce people-oriented and scientific education system for the greater interest of the student community and the people.

2. To establish parliamentary democracy through direct election on adult franchise. To promote liberty of speech, personal liberty and liberty of press. To withdraw prohibitive order imposed upon the Ittefaq.

3. To give full autonomy to East Pakistan on the basis of fulfillment of the following demands:

(a) The constitutional structure of the country shall be a federation of states and the power of the legislature shall be supreme.

(b) The jurisdiction of the federal government shall be limited to defence, foreign policy and currency, and the power of the federating states shall be supreme in all matters.

(c) Common currency shall be in circulation in two wings of the country having the system under the jurisdiction of the centre. But there should be specific provision in the Constitution so that the currency of East Pakistan cannot be laundered to West Pakistan. Under this system there shall be a federal reserve bank in Pakistan. There will be two separate reserve banks in two wings, and separate economy for East Pakistan shall have to be introduced.

(d) The fixation of all kinds of taxes, land revenue and duties, and the collection of such taxes shall be vested with the regional government. The Federal government shall have no power to fix and impose any tax. A fixed portion of the revenue collected by the regional government shall immediately be deposited to the federal fund. Mandatory rules on the reserve banks to that end shall be incorporated in the Constitution.

(e) Each of the federating states shall maintain separate accounts of external trade, and the remittance earned through external trade will lie with the federating states. The federating states shall provide for the necessary foreign currency to the federal government equally or as prescribed in the specific Article of the Constitution. The inter states import and export of inland commodities shall be free of custom duties. Provision shall have to be made in the Constitution guaranteeing the exclusive right of the federating states in executing trade agreements with the foreign states, establishing trade mission abroad, and in conducting import and export trade.

(f) To provide East Pakistan with an authority of forming a militia or para-military Rakshi Bahini. To establish ordnance factory and the naval headquarters in East Pakistan.

4. To constitute sub-federation by giving autonomy to all the provinces including Beluchistan, North-West Frontier Province and Sind of West Pakistan.
5. To nationalize bank, insurance, jute trade and large-scale industries.
6. To reduce the rate of land revenue and taxes imposed upon the peasants, and to exempt arrear land tax and outstanding debt. To annul the certificate system and to stop the repression of the tahsildars. To fix the minimum price of jute at taka 40 per maund and to ensure legitimate price of sugar-cane.
7. To pay legitimate wage and bonus to the labourers and to arrange for their education, housing, medical treatment etc. To withdraw all black-laws detrimental to the interest of the labourers, and to ensure their right to strike and right to trade union activities.
8. To take steps towards flood control measures in East Pakistan, and to ensure overall utilization of water resources.
9. To withdraw Emergency Act, Safety Act and other repressive Acts.
10. To annul SEATO, CENTO agreements, Pak-American Military Pact and to ensure non-aligned independent and neutral foreign policy.
11. To release immediately all the students, labourers, peasants, political activists and leaders, detained in different jails of the country, to repeal warrant and hulia, and to withdraw all the cases instituted on political grounds including the Agartala Conspiracy Case.

The Six Points demand of Awami League had its wide reflection on the Eleven Points demand of the Chhatra Sangram Parishad. The demands relating to the interest of the Bangali middle class peasants and workers were also included in the Eleven Points demand. Consequently, the Eleven Points movement addressed wide public support in East Pakistan, and the leadership of the anti-Ayub movement virtually came within the grip of the student leaders. The student movement was initiated in October 1968, reached its climax in January 1969, and by mid January culminated into a mass movement. The Eleven Points movement of the students had direct contribution towards preparing the background of the War of Liberation.

MASS UPRISING OF 1969:

The 1969 uprising in East Pakistan was a democratic political movement in East Pakistan (now Bangladesh). The mass uprising in 1969 is that the entire people of East Pakistan staged against the dictator Ayub Khan on the basis of six points and 11 points in 1969 with the aim of implementing democracy and establishing autonomy and ending all anti-people forces and military rule is known as the 1969 uprising. The uprising consisted of a series of mass demonstrations and sporadic conflicts between government armed forces and the demonstrators. Although the unrest began in 1966 with the Six point movement of Awami League, it got momentum at the beginning of 1969 and culminated in the resignation of Field Marshal Ayub Khan, the first military ruler of Pakistan. The uprising also led to the withdrawal of Agartala Conspiracy Case and acquittal of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and his colleagues from the case.

The mass uprising of 1969 brought down the oppressive and dictatorial ruler Ayub Khan.

Background of the Mass Uprising in 1969:

- Reluctance to grant autonomy to East Pakistan.
- An unreasonable decision to make Urdu the state language.
- The election of 1954.
- Military rule which was imposed in 1958.
- Boundless inequality between East and West Pakistan.
- Students movement of 1962 and 1964
- Six-point movement and reluctance to grant autonomy.
- Agartala conspiracy case of 1968. ∞

Movements of Mass Uprising:

The mass uprising of 1969 was divided into three stages.

1. From 4th January to 19th January 1969.
2. January 20, 1969 to February 22.
3. From February 23 to March 25, 1969.

Starting from the Language Movement various nationalistic movements ensued during the decade of 1960. These movements were against the racial repressions, deprivation and disparity done to East Pakistan since the inception of Pakistan.

Those factors had their impact on the mass upsurge in 1969. The student agitation turned into a vigorous mass movement under the leadership of Maulana Bhashani. As a part of joint program, the National Awami Party, East Pakistan Workers' Federation and East Pakistan Peasants' Association arranged a public meeting at Paltan Maidan to observe the Repression Resistance Day on 6 December 1968. Maulana Bhashani declared a hartal the next day, following the violent clash between the police and the demonstrators. Awami League observed Repression Resistance Day on 10 December. A 'gherao' program was staged on 29 December. The leaders of Chhatra League, Chhatra Union (Matia and Menon group) and Dhaka University Central Students Union (DUCSU) sat together on 4 January 1969 and formed a united front known as Sarbadaliya Chhatra Sangram Parishad (All Parties Student Resistance Council). Chhatra Sangram Parishad presented 11 points program which was, by and large, a combination of the six points of Bangabandhu and few other demands. 11 points got support of the Bangalees from all strata of life very soon. During the time of turmoil in 1969, students' 11 point program was a very timely manifestation of the demands of the opposition parties in East Pakistan. This brought the opposition parties together to be united quite rapidly. On 8 January eight parties formed an alliance known as 'Gonotantrik Sangram Parishad' (Democratic Action Committee/DAC) and placed forward 8 points demand. On 20 January students observed hartal in East Pakistan to protest that brutality. During hartal police fired open in front of Dhaka Medical College and a student leader Asaduzzaman was killed. In protest of killing Asad, students undertook extensive program on 22, 23 and 24 January. Sergeant Zahurul Haque, an under-trial prisoner in the Agartala Conspiracy Case, was killed brutally by gun shot in Dhaka Cantonment on 15 February. The movement triggered off in protest of the killing of Zahurul Haque on 16 February. Finding no other alternative, the Government imposed curfew in Dhaka. On 18 February the army bayoneted Dr. Mohammad Shamsuzzoha, the then Proctor of Rajshahi University and killed him. Ayub Khan could realize that the situation would go beyond control unless the Agartala Case was withdrawn and the accused people were released. All the accused including Sheikh Mujibur Rahman were released on 22 February 1969. Yielding to the Martyred student leader Asad murdered by firing of Police pressure of the mass uprising Ayub Khan declared that he would not contest in the next presidential election.

Importance/Significance of the Mass Uprising:

- On March 25, 1969, Ayub Khan was forced to resign.

- ❑ The Agartala conspiracy case was withdrawn on 22 February.
- ❑ Sheikh Mujibur Rahman was conferred the title of Bangabandhu.
- ❑ Awareness of rights of Bengalis increased.
- ❑ Democratic aspirations are awakened.
- ❑ Inequality between East and West Pakistan came to an end.
- ❑ The political prisoners were released from prison.
- ❑ Bengali nationalism was created.
- ❑ The mass uprising of 1969 played a vital role in 1970 elections.
- ❑ The mass uprising of 1969 inspired the war of independence.

THE 1970 BHOLA CYCLONE

The 1970 Bhola cyclone (also known as the Great Cyclone of 1970) was a devastating tropical cyclone that struck East Pakistan (present-day Bangladesh) and India's West Bengal on November 12, 1970. It remains the deadliest tropical cyclone ever recorded and one of the world's deadliest humanitarian disasters. At least 300,000 people died in the storm, possibly as many as 500,000, primarily as a result of the storm surge that flooded much of the low-lying islands of the Ganges Delta. Bhola was the sixth and strongest cyclonic storm of the 1970 North Indian Ocean cyclone season.

The cyclone formed over the central Bay of Bengal on November 8 and traveled northward, intensifying as it did so. It reached its peak with winds of 185 km/h (115 mph) on November 10, and made landfall on the coast of East Pakistan on the following afternoon. The storm surge devastated many of the offshore islands, wiping out villages and destroying crops throughout the region. In the most severely affected upazila, Tazumuddin, over 45% of the population of 167,000 were killed by the storm.

The Pakistani government, led by junta leader General Yahya Khan, was criticized for its delayed handling of relief operations following the storm, both by local political leaders in East Pakistan and by the international media. During the election that took place a month later, the opposition Awami League gained a landslide victory in the province, and continuing unrest between East Pakistan and the central government triggered the Bangladesh Liberation War, which led to the 1971 Bangladesh genocide and eventually concluded with the creation of the independent country of Bangladesh.

THE ELECTION OF 1970:

The election of 1970 has a great significance in the history of the liberation movement of Bangladesh. General elections were held in Pakistan on December 7, 1970 – 50 years ago today – to elect members of the National Assembly. This was the first general elections since the independence of Pakistan and ultimately the only ones held prior to the independence of Bangladesh. Voting took place in 300 constituencies, of which 162 were in East Pakistan and 138 in West Pakistan. The elections were a fierce contest between two social democratic parties – the west-based Pakistan Peoples Party (PPP) of Zulfikar Ali Bhutto and the east-based Awami League of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman.

Background of the 1970's Election:

Since the creation of Pakistan, the people of East Pakistan have been the victims of exploitation in West Pakistan. The boundless inequality between East and West Pakistan, the language movement of 1952, the movement against the military rule of 1958 started in East Pakistan. Autonomy was demanded in 1966 through the six points. But the Pakistani ruling class did not listen, instead they filed Agartala conspiracy case to suppress the movement. As a result, the movement became more widespread.

When the military rulers of Pakistan enforced oppressive measures on the leaders of East Pakistan including Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, the people of this country organized a movement against them. This was resulted in the mass uprising of 1969. As Ayub Khan stepped down following this uprising of 25 March, his successor General Yahya Khan promised re-establishment of democracy in Pakistan. He declared that the military government would relegate power to the elected public representatives. Following this route, a general election was held in 1970.

By government order, elections to the National Assembly were announced on 5 October 1970 and to the Provincial Assembly on 22 October. But the election was not held for several reasons. Subsequently, elections to the National Assembly were held on 6 December 1970 and to the Provincial Assembly on 16 December. But on 12 November, a severe cyclone and tidal wave in some parts of East Pakistan destroyed property worth crores of rupees and houses. As a result, elections were held on 17 January 1971 in those areas. There were 17 political parties participating in this election.

The Legal framework order:

On 28 March, 1970, Yahya Khan announced the basic principles of the legal framework order relating to election.

- National Assembly of Pakistan will consist of 313 seats with 13 seats reserved for women.
- 169 seats were to be for East Pakistan, 85 for Punjab, 28 for Sindh, 19 for NWFP, 5 for Baluchistan and 7 seats were allotted to the tribal areas.
- Legislatures shall be elected through direct elections on the basis of population and adult franchise.
- Within a specified period, economic and all other disparities between different provinces and areas shall be removed.
- The independence of the judiciary shall be secured.

Results of the 1970's Election:

- In the National Assembly elections, the Awami League won 167 seats, including 7 reserved seats for women, and the Pakistan People's Party got only 88 seats.
- On the other hand, in the East Pakistan Provincial Assembly, Awami League held absolute majority by bagging 298 out of a total of 310 seats.
- An analysis of the election results shows that, in National Assembly, Awami League won 75.10% of the total vote whereas in Provincial Assembly, they got a 70.48% of the total vote.

Importance/Significance of the election:

- ☐ The election of 1970 had enormous significance for the emergence of an independent and sovereign Bangladesh and Bangalee nationalism.
- ☐ The popularity of Awami League increased.
- ☐ Democratic aspirations are awakened.
- ☐ The political awareness of Bengalis increased.
- ☐ Sheikh Mujib's status was increased.

- ☐ Regional dominance increases.
- ☐ Played an important role to the Liberation War.

Reasons for the victory of Awami League in the election of 1970:

- ☐ Reluctance to provide Elections
- ☐ Boundless inequality between East and West Pakistan.
- ☐ Agartala conspiracy case
- ☐ Impact of Pak-India war
- ☐ leadership of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman
- ☐ The isolation of the Muslim League
- ☐ Influence of Bengali nationalism

THE NON-COOPERATION MOVEMENT OF 1971

The non-cooperation movement of 1971 was a historical movement in then East Pakistan (now Bangladesh) by the Awami League and the general public against the military government of Pakistan in March of that year. After the announcement of the suspension of the session of the National Assembly of Pakistan on 1 March, the spontaneous movement of the people started, but officially on the call of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, the non-cooperation movement started on 2 March and continued until 25 March. The movement lasted for a total of 25 days. The main objective of this movement was to ensure the autonomy of East Pakistan from the central government of Pakistan. During this period, the control of the central government of West Pakistan over the civilian administration of East Pakistan was almost non-existent. At one stage of the movement, the whole of East Pakistan, except the cantonments, was practically under the command of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman.

Background

In 1940, A. K. Fazlul Huq presented the Lahore Resolution as a promoter at the All India Muslim League conference held in Lahore, Province of Punjab. The third article of the Lahore Resolution called for the creation of a number of independent and sovereign Muslim majority states in British-ruled India by specifically adjusting the boundaries of places as territories on the basis of geographical location.

But the Muslim League did not implement the article, instead amending the Lahore Resolution in the Delhi Resolution of 1946 to create a single Muslim state in the Indian subcontinent in 1947 with all Muslim-majority areas. During the partition of India, Bengal was divided into two parts by religion. The Hindu-dominated West Bengal region was incorporated into India and the Muslim-dominated East Bengal region into Pakistan. In 1955, the name of the province of East Bengal was changed to East Pakistan.

Although East Pakistan was governed as a region of Pakistan under the One Unit Scheme, the region was discriminated against politically, financially, culturally, and militarily. Nineteen years after the establishment of Pakistan, the Awami League demanded the implementation of a federal system in the state as one of the phases of the six-point movement. The system allows the administrative regions to remain independent under the central government.

Within four years from 1966, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, as the president of the Awami League, was able to unite the people of East Pakistan in favor of Bengali nationalism.

1970 General Election Results

In the 1970 general election, the Awami League won an absolute majority in the country's National Assembly, winning 167 of the 313 seats, including reserved seats for women.

As a result of this victory of the Awami League, the leaders of other political parties in West Pakistan, including the Pakistan People's Party, were afraid to realize that the implementation of the six points was inevitable. The ruling group felt that the unity of Pakistan would be destroyed if the six points were implemented.

Yahya Khan, the president of Pakistan, came to Dacca (present-day Dhaka) on 12 January 1971. He held two rounds of talks with Sheikh Mujibur Rahman. Sheikh Mujibur Rahman said about this discussion:

The talks were satisfactory and the President agreed to convene a session of the National Assembly in Dacca soon.

The then President of Pakistan, Yahya Khan Similarly, before returning to West Pakistan, President Yahya Khan told reporters,

What Sheikh Mujib, the future Prime Minister of the country said about the talks with him, is absolutely correct.

Returning to West Pakistan, he went to Zulfikar Ali Bhutto's residence in Larkana and held a secret meeting with the generals.

Then Zulfikar Ali Bhutto came to Dacca with other leaders of the party on the 27th, 28th, and 29th and held several rounds of meetings with Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and other top leaders of the Awami League at Hotel Intercontinental.

In the meeting on the 27th, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman rejected Bhutto's offer to form an alliance and share power. After the meeting, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman planned to organize a meeting of the National Assembly by 15 February and formulate a constitution based on the six points, but Zulfikar Ali Bhutto further discussed. He expressed the opinion that it is necessary to do.

He proposed to hold a session of the National Assembly at the end of March. However, President Yahya Khan convened a session of the National Assembly on 3

March. But on 15 February Zulfikar Ali Bhutto announced that he and his party would not attend the session unless the Awami League compromised on their 6 points or changed them.

Four days later on 19 February, Yahya Khan discussed with Zulfikar Ali Bhutto about the next step. After the meeting, Bhutto repeated the same claim. He remained adamant about not attending the session if the Awami League did not meet his conditions.

On 28 February, he warned that he would start agitation if the session started without his party. He also threatened to kill members of the Constituent Assembly who wanted to attend the session from West Pakistan in Dacca.

Sheikh Mujibur Rahman understood that the West Pakistanis were planning to sabotage the election results. So he was making tough decisions day by day. President Yahya Khan, in consultation with Bhutto, adjourned the National Assembly session indefinitely on 1 March. As a result, the people of Bengal burst into anger; the movement began.

Initial phase (1–7 March)

1 March

A copy of The Daily Ittefaq, which was published the next day, covered the events of 1 March

General Yahya Khan announced the adjournment of the National Assembly session on 1 March 1971 at 1:50 PM (UTC+6) on 1 March 1971, following a threat by Zulfikar Ali Bhutto, the leader of Pakistan's second largest party, Pakistan People's Party.

During this announcement, the ongoing cricket match between International XI vs BCCP at the Dacca Stadium was stopped in the face of public protests. The student crowd went into a spontaneous movement without any guidance from Sheikh Mujibur Rahman. The students first gathered in groups at Battala of the University of Dacca and decided to hold a public meeting at Paltan Maidan.

On that day, the members of the Awami League parliamentary party including Sheikh Mujibur Rahman were busy drafting the constitution based on the 6 points at Hotel Purbani, so the angry crowd gathered in front of the hotel. There, the crowd

burned the Pakistani flag and pictures of Muhammad Ali Jinnah. Sheikh Mujibur Rahman then held a press conference and advised everyone to continue the movement peacefully. He simultaneously announced a hartal until 2 pm on 2 and 3 March and decided to hold a public meeting at the Race Course Maidan on 7 March.

That evening, Muhammad Iqbal Hall and Muhammad Ali Jinnah Hall of Dacca University were renamed as Shahid Sergeant Zahurul Haque Hall and Surya Sen Hall respectively.

On this day, under the instruction of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, Nur-e-Alam Siddiqui, Shajahan Siraj, A. S. M. Abdur Rab, and Abdul Kuddas Makhan founded the Swadhin Bangla Chhatra Sangram Parishad (lit. 'Independent Bengal Student Struggle Council') in the afternoon after a secret meeting.

2 March

A. S. M. Abdur Rab, the then vice-president of DUCSU and the first national flag hoister of Bangladesh.

On this day, "Independent Bengal Student Struggle Council" under the leadership of A. S. M. Abdur Rab, the vice-president of Dhaka University Central Students' Union, was the first to raise the flag of independent Bangladesh with its map.

On this day Sahabzada Yaqub Khan was appointed Governor of East Pakistan. Despite martial law and the imposition of a curfew from 7 pm to 7 am, widespread agitation continued. A strike was observed in Dacca till 2 pm. The movement was fired upon. At Paltan Maidan, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman called for a nationwide strike until 3 March and announced his decision to address the nation on 7 March. He also said that the program of the movement to achieve autonomy would be outlined in the speech.

On the same day, the East Bengal Labor Movement handed over pamphlets to people calling to Sheikh Mujibur Rahman for the independence of East Pakistan by fighting against the central government of Pakistan. In the evening, Awami League's branch in Karachi held discussions with Pakistani political parties. The Pakistan People's Party was absent from the discussion aimed at the latest political situation in Pakistan. In the meeting, the Awami League demanded to hold the National Assembly session by 7 March.

On this day, there were reports of looting of shops by unknown perpetrator in various parts of East Pakistan. The people resisted the looters and burnt the looted goods. A curfew was imposed in Dacca through radio announcements at night. When the students broke the curfew and took out a procession at night, they were fired upon in different parts of the city.

3 March

On this day, in the presence of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman at Paltan Maidan, under the banner of Student Struggle Council, Shajahan Siraj, the then General Secretary of Chhatra League announced the independence manifesto of Bangladesh. It declared East Pakistan to become an independent and sovereign state called Bangladesh as well as defining its goals.

On this day, almost all government, semi-government and autonomous offices and institutions of East Pakistan, Secretariat, High Court and other courts, Pakistan International Airlines, Railways and all other communication media, industrial and commercial institutions were observed in all places in the country and meetings and marches were held. A procession was held on this day with the bodies of several people who had been shot dead the previous night. Many places in East Pakistan were shot at during these processions. As a result, 75 people were shot dead in Chittagong besides 23 people in the city of Dacca. Curfew was imposed in Dacca, Rangpur and Sylhet.

Yahya Khan announced the decision to hold a conference of leaders in Dacca on 10 March and promised to start the National Assembly session within two weeks of this conference. Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto agreed but Sheikh Mujibur Rahman rejected it. Sheikh Mujibur Rahman told Bhutto that if the Bhuttos did not want to accept a democratically constituted system of governance, then a separate system of governance would be created for East Pakistan.

At night, when troops and goods were disembarked from the MV Swat ship at Chittagong port, a clash broke out between the army and the protesting sailors. Seven army personnel were tried by a court-martial and sentenced to death by the Pakistan Army after refusing to open fire on the protesters.

4 March

Sahebzada Yakub Khan acted as Governor of East Pakistan from 2 to 4 March. Curfew was lifted from the provincial capital. But Martial Law No. 113 was issued in the district and hill tracts area in Chittagong. East Pakistani artists and journalists

joined the movement. On this day, Abdul Hamid Khan Bhashani, the president of National Awami Party, demanded the rights of the people of this country based on the Lahore Resolution of 1940. Sahibzada Yakub Khan, the chief martial law administrator of East Pakistan, resigned as the situation deteriorated.

East Pakistani politician Nurul Amin called on Yahya Khan to convene a session of the National Assembly that day. At a press conference in Karachi, Asghar Khan called on the central government to give power to Awami League to maintain the unity of Pakistan.

On this day, Radio Pakistan and the Dhaka center of Pakistan Television, the government television channel, changed their names to Dacca Betar Kendro lit. 'Dacca Radio Centre' and Dacca Television respectively. From this day to 6 March, Sheikh Mujib ordered a strike from six in the morning to two in the afternoon.

5 March

The movement continued. 4 people were killed and 25 were injured in the shooting in Tongi. As a result of firing in Chittagong, the death toll has increased to 138. Curfew was again imposed in Rangpur and Rajshahi. The teachers of University of Dacca and East Pakistan University of Engineering and Technology joined the movement.

From this day, on the orders of Sheikh Mujib, all government and private offices, banks, ration shops are open from 2.30 pm to 4.00 pm only for urgent needs and for the purpose of paying salaries to employees.

Bhutto and other leaders of the People's Party had a long meeting with Yahya Khan in Rawalpindi. After the meeting, the spokesperson of the party, Abdul Hafiz Pirzada, called the response of the Awami League unwanted and unreasonable in view of the suspension of the National Assembly session.

A absentee funeral prayer of those killed in the ongoing movement in East Pakistan was organized in Lahore, West Pakistan. Prayers and prayers are offered in memory of the victims after friday prayers in various mosques of East Pakistan.

6 March

General Yahya Khan in his address to the nation announced that the National Assembly session would be held on 25 March. Tikka Khan was appointed as the Governor of East Pakistan. Flights of Pakistan over Indian airspace remain banned.

After Yahya Khan's speech, an emergency joint meeting of the executive committee of the central and eastern branches of Pakistani Awami League was held. After several hours of closed-door meeting, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman refused to enter into negotiations with Yahya Khan "trampling on the blood of martyrs."

14 people were injured and 1 person was killed in Rajshahi that day. 86 people were injured and 18 people were killed in Khulna. On the other hand, 341 prisoners escaped by breaking the gate of Dhaka Central Jail.

7 March

On this day, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman delivered the historic 7 March speech to the nation at Race Course Maidan (now Suhrawardy Udyan) in Dhaka. In his speech, he said that if 4 conditions are fulfilled, he will join the session. They are:

Martial law must be withdrawn immediately.

Military men should go back to barracks.

Genocide must be investigated

Power must be transferred to the people's representatives.

He forbade the people of Bengal to pay tax. All the courts of East Pakistan, including the secretariat, other government and semi-government offices, the eastern branch of Supreme Court and the Dacca High Court, were asked to remain closed. However, he allowed to keep the bank open only for 2 hours daily. Allowed all types of bus-trucks, rickshaws, taxis for the transportation of civilians other than the military.

Dacca Betar was shut down that day in protest of Bengali activists for not airing this speech. The angry crowd threw bombs in front of the Betar building at seven in the evening.

That day President Yahya Khan appointed five military officers, including Lieut. General Amir Abdullah Khan Niazi, as Assistant Military Administrators.

Middle phase (8–15 March)

8 March

The non-cooperation movement took a new form after Sheikh Mujibur Rahman's speech on 7 March. Student leaders declared solidarity with this speech. Sheikh Mujibur Rahman's speech will be aired - on this condition the radio workers joined the work. Chhatra League leaders proposed to form 'Swadhin Bangladesh Chhatra

Sangam Parishad' (lit. 'Independent Bangladesh Students Struggle Council') on this day.

Although the speech of 7 March was not broadcast the previous day, due to the pressure of the situation, this speech was broadcast from Dacca Betar at 8:30 am. It is also relayed from other radio stations in East Pakistan.

An official press note claimed that 172 people were killed and 358 injured in the ongoing agitation. But on behalf of the Awami League, the party's general secretary Tajuddin Ahmad protested this press note of the military authorities and complained that the number of casualties had been greatly reduced.

As per Sheikh Mujibur Rahman's 7 March speech, all government offices began to come to a standstill. Tikka Khan came to Dhaka on this day to serve as the military governor of East Pakistan.

In a statement at night, Tajuddin Ahmad explained the various instructions announced by Bangabandhu in his 7 March speech. There are mentions:

The bank will be open from 9 am to 3 pm. Besides, it is said to keep the Post Office Savings Bank open. According to the directive, banks are only allowed to transact within Bangladesh (actually East Pakistan). Besides, customers are allowed to pay up to a maximum of Rs. 1,000.

Essential areas for electricity, water, gas and fertilizer supply and diesel supply to power pumps were ordered to remain operational.

Also on that day, share prices of East Pakistan-based companies on the Karachi Stock Exchange fell sharply.

9 March

On this day, the control over the civil administration of East Pakistan to the central government almost stopped. As a result, the then general secretary of Awami League, Tajuddin Ahmad, issued 16-point instructions on behalf of Awami League for the management of civil administration. Pakistan National League leader Aatur Rahman Khan and Chhatra League leaders advised Sheikh Mujibur Rahman to form a "Bangladesh National Government" that day.

On this day, NAP leader Maulana Abdul Hamid Khan Bhasani and Sheikh Mujibur Rahman discussed the political situation of the country. That afternoon, in a speech at Paltan Maidan, Maulana Bhasani announced his decision to join forces with

Sheikh Mujibur Rahman. He also asked Yahya Khan to accept the independence of East Bengal. He also announced that if no effective action was taken by the government by 25 March, he would launch a simultaneous mass movement like in 1952.

Tikka Khan took over the duties of Chief Martial Law Administrator on this day. But Badruddin Ahmed Siddiky, Chief Justice of East Pakistan, told him that he was unable to take oath.

On this day, the military authorities issued an indefinite curfew in the city of Rajshahi for the next 8 hours from 9 pm.

Citizens of other countries in Dhaka landed in the city to take back their respective countries. The UN Secretary-General ordered the removal of their workers from Dhaka if necessary. On the same day, the East Pakistan Communist Party called on the people to fight for the independence of East Pakistan.

10 March

On this day, actors and other artists of the country, led by poet Golam Mustafa and Khan Ataur Rahman, protested under the banner of 'Disgruntled Artist Society'. Class II Bengali employees of the Pakistan Civil Service expressed their loyalty to the Awami League-led movement.

On this day, black flags were hoisted at various places across the country as part of the protest. Even government and private office buildings, Rajarbagh Police Line, various police stations and the house of the Chief Justice of Dhaka High Court were also hoisted.

The indefinite night curfew issued in Rajshahi city was withdrawn today.

On this day, the armed ship 'MV Swat' from West Pakistan arrived at Chittagong port and anchored. But the dock workers refused to take the weapons off the ship. The military attempted to lower the weapons, but the crowd successfully resisted.

On this day, Zulfikar Ali Bhutto offered to meet Sheikh Mujibur Rahman in a telegram message, pleading to save the state.

11 March

Bhutto, the leader of the PPP, sent a telegram to Sheikh Mujibur Rahman to come to Dacca to agree to negotiate. As Khulna Newsprint Mill stopped sending paper to

West Pakistan from 1 March, the quality of various newspapers including Dawn decreased drastically from that day on due to the lack of newsprint.

A statement of Swadhin Bangla Chhatra Sangam Parishad called for the boycott of titles and medals given by the government. Therefore, on that day, U Thant, the then Secretary General of the United Nations, ordered all their officers and employees working in East Pakistan to return to the United Nations Headquarters.

Tajuddin Ahmed on behalf of Awami League published 14-point instructions for the purpose of the common people for the management of civil administration. Also on this day representatives of various parties of West Pakistan met with Sheikh Mujib.

A ship named 'Vintage Horizon' carrying 32 thousand tons of wheat from the United States of America was coming to Chittagong Port for Pakistan. But the Pakistani government ordered the ship to go to Karachi port that day.

12 March

On this day, Awami League ordered the formation of Sangram Parishad in every union of the province. Bengali CSP and EPCS officers working in East Pakistan, employees of government and semi-government and autonomous organizations supported the movement. The CSP officers donated their one-day salary to the fund of Awami League on this day. The owners announced the closure of all movie theaters in East Pakistan for an indefinite period. They donated Rs. 13,250 to the Awami League relief fund for the movement.

In view of the ongoing movement, the military government announced the cancellation of all pre-scheduled events including the parade of the Armed Forces, awarding of titles, to be held on the occasion of Pakistan's Republic Day on 23 March. Awami League leader Muhammad Mansur Ali expressed deep concern and condemnation that the US food cargo ship sent to East Pakistan was diverted to Karachi instead of Chittagong. Maulana Bhasani reiterated his support for Awami League in a public meeting in Mymensingh that day.

On this day, 27 prisoners escaped from the jail in Bogra. 1 inmate was killed and 15 wounded by guards during the escape.

13 March

All salaried officers and employees from the defense sector were ordered to join the workplace on the morning of 15 March. If the order is not obeyed, they are

threatened with dismissal from the job. Calling it provocative, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman strongly opposed this decision.

265 officials from West Germany, the United States, the United Kingdom, Italy, Canada, France and the United Nations were sent back to their respective countries from Dacca.

On the same day, the leaders of various opposition parties in West Pakistan such as Council Muslim League, Convention Muslim League, Jamiat Ulema-e-Islam, Jamiat Ulema-e-Pakistan organized a meeting regarding the ongoing situation. PPP and Pakistan Muslim League (Qayyum) were absent from the meeting. At the end of the meeting, they demanded immediate transfer of power to Awami League to prevent the inevitable disintegration of Pakistan. Abdul Hakeem Chowdhury and Zainul Abedin renounced their titles in support of the movement.

14 March

Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto proposed to Yahya Khan the formula to give power to Awami League in East Pakistan and PPP in West Pakistan, i.e. two parties in two Pakistans. The leaders of almost all the political parties in Pakistan at the time except Muslim League's Abdul Qayyum Khan criticized this stubborn and undemocratic decision.

Western industrialists affected by the non-cooperation movement submitted a memorandum to the military government to accept Sheikh Mujibur Rahman's four points.

Sheikh Mujibur Rahman published an instruction book containing 35 instructions regarding the movement. The purpose of these instructions was to inform how to manage the movement without harming the country's economy.

15 March

On this day, the control of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and Awami League was established in all areas of the province except the cantonments.

Yahya Khan came to Dacca that day to discuss with Sheikh Mujibur Rahman. His itinerary was secret. He did not speak to reporters at the airport.

There were massive protests in West Pakistan against Bhutto's proposal to give power to two parties in two Pakistans. Leaders of other parties in West Pakistan strongly opposed his decision, calling it undemocratic.

Final phase (16–25 March)

16 March

A procession led by Zainul Abedin and Sufia Kamal on 16 March

A report published in Newsweek that day said that he actually declared independence in his 7 March speech.

A meeting began between Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and Yahya Khan. After discussing with local leaders, he went to the Governor's House. On his way to the meeting, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman rode in a white car with a black flag on the front and a map of Bangladesh on the window shield.

In the meeting, Yahya Khan expressed his regret to Sheikh Mujibur Rahman for the previous incidents and wished to solve the problem politically. Then he said that he accepted the 4-point condition of power transfer proposed by Awami League. The terms were – removal of military rule and transfer of power to a democratic government, transfer of power to majority political parties in each province, retention of Yahya Khan's presidency as head of the central government, and two Pakistani members of the National Assembly meeting separately.

17 March

On this day, the second round of talks took place between Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and Yahya Khan. However, neither the military government nor the Awami League have disclosed details about this discussion.

On this day, in a public meeting in Chittagong, the president of NAP, Maulana Abdul Hamid Khan Bhasani, called to celebrate that day as 'Independent East Bengal Day' instead of the Republic Day of Pakistan on 23 March.

The government formed a five-member inquiry committee to investigate the ongoing killings from 1 March. But that inquiry committee was rejected by Sheikh Mujibur Rahman. On the same day, Yahya Khan ordered Khadim Hussain Raja to finally implement Operation Searchlight.

18 March

There was no meeting between Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and Yahya Khan on that day.

Awami League rejected the aforementioned inquiry committee. On the other hand, another 3-member inquiry committee consist of Khondaker Mostaq Ahmad, Abidur Reza Khan and Muhammad Mansur Ali was created by Awami League.

19 March

The fourth meeting between Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and Yahya Khan took place. It was decided in the meeting that the next day Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and Yahya Khan would discuss with their advisors. Therefore, on this day, a separate meeting was held between the advisory councils. On behalf of Yahya Khan, Gul Hassan Khan, Lieutenant General S.G.M.M Pirzada and Alvin Robert Cornelius and Tajuddin Ahmed, Kamal Hossain and Syed Nazrul Islam participated on behalf of Awami League. On this day they had a meeting about the topic of the next day's discussion. But during the negotiations, Pak forces opened fire on the crowd in Rangpur, Syedpur and Joydevpur. The Bengalis were able to resist the Pakistani army in Jaidebpur. Sheikh Mujibur Rahman said that he would not join the parliament unless there was an impartial investigation into the massacre by the army.

20 March

That day, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman came to discuss with 6 representatives of Awami League (top leaders) named Syed Nazrul Islam, Khondaker Mostaq Ahmed, Tajuddin Ahmed, Kamal Hossain, M. Mansoor Ali and Abul Hasnat Muhammad Qamaruzzaman. On the other hand, among the representatives of Yahya Khan was Lieutenant General S.G.M.M Pirzada, AR Cornelius, and Col Hassan. Representatives of both sides met twice.

After the meeting, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman reported some progress in the discussion. He also informed that he and his advisers will meet with the President and his advisers the next day.

On this day, the government asked all civilians of the country to submit their licensed weapons to the nearest police station.

21 March

On that day, in the meeting between Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and Yahya Khan, the then General Secretary of Awami League Tajuddin Ahmed helped Sheikh Mujibur Rahman in the discussion.

Leader of PPP along with 12 advisors came to Dacca to join the discussion. Maulana Bhasani called everyone in Chittagong to join the movement under the leadership of Awami League.

The Central Chhatra Sangram Parishad began preparations to observe Pakistan Day as "Resistance Day" on this day. Other political and social organizations supported their proposals. From Pakistan Day, the Swadhin Bangladesh Sramik Sangam Parishad (lit. 'Independent Bangladesh Labour Struggle Council') called for a boycott of West Pakistani products.

22 March

As Sheikh Mujibur Rahman was adamant about not attending the session of the National Assembly if martial law was not withdrawn, President Yahya Khan again announced the suspension of the session of the National Assembly.

Tripartite talks were held between Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, Yahya Khan and Zulfikar Ali Bhutto. Also on this day there was a discussion between four advisers of Yahya Khan and five lawyers of Pakistan Peoples Party. With the argument of legal complications, they strongly opposed giving power to Sheikh Mujibur Rahman by withdrawing martial law before the session. Also on this day President Yahya Khan discussed this issue with other leaders of West Pakistan.

Zulfikar Ali Bhutto opposed the demand of Awami League to abolish military rule and transfer power to a democratic government by president, saying that if Awami League's demand is implemented, the president's order will lose legal validity by creating a constitutional vacuum. However, in a written statement on this day, A. K. Brohi stated that the 4 clauses in the transfer of power were not inconsistent with the law.

23 March

On this day, the flag with the map of independent Bangladesh was hoisted in place of the Pakistani flag everywhere in East Pakistan, except the cantonment, airport and governor's house. On this day, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman officially hoisted this flag for the first time at his house on Road No. 32 in Dhanmondi. According to his pre-announced instructions, a general holiday is observed across the country on this day. Maulana Bhasani's NAP observed the Pakistan Day as 'Independent East Bengal Day'.

On this day, the flag of independent Bangladesh was hoisted by protesters at the diplomatic offices of different countries in Dacca. The flag of independent Bengal was hoisted at the British Deputy High Commission and the Soviet Consulate in the morning. The Pakistani flags were hoisted by the supporters of Pakistan at the embassies of China, Indonesia, Iran and Nepal, Pakistan's ally at the time, first, but later the students lowered them and hoisted the map-embossed Bangladesh flag. However, no flag was hoisted at the US consulate in Dacca that day.

Due to the unstable situation in the country, President of Pakistan Yahya Khan canceled the scheduled Republic Day speech and issued a written statement.

Although there was no discussion between Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and Yahya Khan on that day, there was a discussion between Awami League and President Yahya Khan's advisers. Awami League representatives presented the draft proposal of the 6-point system of governance. In the evening, the economic aspects of the regime were discussed again.

Zulfikar Ali Bhutto held a meeting with President Yahya Khan and his Chief Secretary Lt. Gen. Pirzada on this day. Also, leaders of various political parties from West Pakistan came to Dacca and held a meeting with Yahya Khan that day.

On the same day, riots between Bengalis and Muhajirs took place in several places in East Pakistan instigated by the Pakistan Army. During the riots there were casualties from army firing.

24 March

Awami League and President Yahya Khan and his advisers discussed the economic sections of the draft constitution proposed on the 23rd.

On this day, Awami League representatives proposed confederation instead of federation in the draft constitution. But the government opposed it as it was in conflict with the constitution of Awami League.

President Yahya Khan held a meeting with People's Party leader Zulfikar Ali Bhutto on that day, but most West Pakistani political party leaders left East Pakistan.

Sheikh Mujibur Rahman advised to strengthen the movement on this day. Tajuddin Ahmad demanded the announcement of the President as soon as possible.

Muhajir residents in Mirpur, with the help of Pakistani army intelligence, lowered Bangladeshi flags and black flags from the roofs of Bengali houses there and set them on fire, causing panic in the area.

The Pakistan Army unloaded its weapons from the MV Swat in Chittagong port and faced strong resistance from fifty thousand people.

25 March

Bhutto held talks with Yahya Khan for 45 minutes that morning. After the discussion, in response to reporters' questions about the proposed autonomy of East Pakistan, Bhutto said that the Awami League's proposed autonomy was not real but rather close to sovereignty.

In addition, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman through a press release announced changes in the points contained in the instructions and added a new point. In addition, the Awami League issued a press release in which the party claimed that Yahya Khan had agreed to hand over power to their party and that they Expect the President to make an announcement in this regard.

On the same day, during the unloading of arms from the MV Swat at the Chittagong port, the general public obstructed it. Pak forces opened fire to avoid the obstacle. After that, curfew or evening law was issued in various parts of East Pakistan due to extreme protests across the country.

The Awami League called a nationwide strike on 27 March to protest the killing of 110 people by Pakistani forces firing on civilians in Joydevpur, Rangpur and Syedpur. On this day, the full report of the draft regime was supposed to be presented to President Yahya Khan, but that meeting did not take place. President Yahya Khan secretly left Dhaka at 4:45 pm on that day.

Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto announced his return to Karachi on 26 March after receiving the news of Yahya Khan's departure from East Pakistan. At a 9pm meeting held at his residence, an hour after receiving the news of Yahya Khan leaving Dhaka, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman expressed fear that he might be killed and Yahya Khan wanted to solve the problem by force of arms. However, he then expressed hope that an independent country called Bangladesh would be created in the future.

Ending and aftermath

On the pretext of protecting the unity of Pakistan and stopping the ongoing non-cooperation movement, Pakistani forces led by Tikka Khan, Rao Farman Ali, and

Khadim Hussain Raja carried out indiscriminate massacres of unarmed sleeping Bengalis in Dhaka from 11:30 pm on 25 March. The non-cooperation movement officially ended when Sheikh Mujibur Rahman declared independence in Bangladesh that night (early hours of 26 March).

In a radio address on the evening of 26 March, Yahya Khan declared the Awami League treasonous and banned the party. In addition to this, the government seized the bank accounts of the Awami League. Although Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and Kamal Hossain were imprisoned, most of the Awami League leaders managed to escape from the government. In such circumstances, the people of East Pakistan began to resist the Pakistan Army and this movement resulted in the liberation war of Bangladesh.

Impact

News of the non-cooperation movement was quickly spread throughout East Pakistan by newspapers and radio. Various published news stories about the Awami League, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, and Yahya Khan in the newspapers of East Pakistan during the movement prove that the media was in favor of the movement at that time. Banks in East Pakistan also contributed to this movement. At that time, patriotic poems and songs written in leaflets in support of the non-cooperation movement were distributed in the branches of the banks.

According to Anthony Mascarenhas, this movement started on 1 March, which has no precedent in the history of Pakistan. The Pakistan Army did not expect any such movement to break out in East Pakistan.

Sharafat Hossain wrote in The Daily Ittefaq that although Sheikh Mujibur Rahman believed in armed struggle like Subhash Chandra Bose, he started a peaceful movement called non-cooperation as a political strategy. Although Mahatma Gandhi conducted his non-cooperation movement in an entirely peaceful India, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman withdrew from the peaceful movement out of necessity. National Awami Party leader Abdul Wali Khan said of the impact of the non-cooperation movement, "Gandhi would have been overwhelmed by this success".

Rehman Sobhan said about this movement that since the beginning of this movement, the existence of a central government in East Bengal was dissolved politically. When the government tried to regain control after 26 March, the people here saw it as foreign interference. According to him the movement was successful and Bangladesh regained its power to rule 213 years after the Battle of Plassey.

Political scientist Rounaq Jahan called the movement an unprecedented mass movement, which she attributed to Yahya Khan's postponement of a pre-scheduled meeting of the Pakistan Constituent Assembly. According to her, during this movement the people of East Pakistan started to consider themselves as citizens of a new state. She also felt that the people's participation in this movement and their desire to be independent created a general will for the independence of Bangladesh.

According to political scientist Zillur Rahman Khan, through this movement, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman established a separate de facto government in the region. The state of Bangladesh was created as a result of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman's contribution in rallying public support against Pakistan's military government.

OPERATION SEARCHLIGHT:

Operation Searchlight was the ruthless and brutal armed operation undertaken by the Pakistan army on 25 March 1971 in order to curb the movement of the freedom loving Bangalis against the autocratic rule of the Pakistani rulers. It was termed as 'Operation Searchlight' by the military authority. The purpose of this operation was to arrest or kill the distinguished Awami League leaders, student leaders and Bangali intellectuals in the main cities of the then East Pakistan including Dhaka, to disarm the Bangali personnels of military, para military and police forces and to capture armoury, radio station and telephone exchange, thereby to take over the control of the province of East Pakistan by ruthlessly curbing the non-cooperation movement headed by Bangabandhu sheikh mujibur Rahman.

Preparation for Genocide:

Genocide conducted by Pakistani soldiers on the night of 25th March, 1971 in the then East Pakistan was named "Operation search light." Though this operation started on the night of 25th March, its preparation had started of the beginning of March. A Ship named M.V. Swayat loaded with arms and weapons reached Chittagong port from West Pakistan on 3rd March. President Yahya stayed at Dhaka from 15- 24th March in the name of discussion with Bangabandhu; but actually he stayed at Dhaka to supervise the preparation of Operation Search light. Major General Rao Farman Ali, Major General Khadim Hossain Raja, General Tikka Khan was the main planner of operation searchlight. The following measures were scheduled to be taken under Operation Searchlight:

- The operation shall be started simultaneously in the whole of East Pakistan.
- Maximum number of politicians and student leaders, teachers and extremist activists of cultural organisations shall have to be arrested.
- The operations in Dhaka shall have to be made a cent percent success. To that end the Dhaka University shall have to be captured.
- All sorts of domestic and international communications must be disrupted. Telephone exchange, radio, TV, teleprinter service, transmitter in the foreign consulates must be disrupted.
- In the first phase, the operational zones will be Dhaka, Khulna, Chittagong, Comilla, Jessore, Rangpur, Syedpur and Sylhet. The operation planning in Chittagong, Sylhet, Jessore, Rangpur and Comilla shall be implemented by air, if necessary.

Genocide by operation search light:

Pakistani soldiers came out at the streets from Dhaka Cantonment at 11.30 pm. on 25th march. A procession in support of liberation became the first target of Pakistani soldiers at Farmghate. At the same time, attack was carried on at Peelkhana and Rajarbagh police line. At 1-30 am they arrested Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman from his residence. At dead of night they launched operation at the residential quarters of the teachers of Dhaka University including the then Iqbal Hall, Jagannath Hall, Rokeya Hall and killed a huge number of students including nine teachers. Under the same planning, serious attack was made on old Dhaka, Tejgaon, Indira Road, Mirpur, Mohammadpur, Dhaka airport, Ganaktuli, Dhanmondi, Kalabagan, Kathalbagan etc. In the same night many people were killed and injured in Chittagong by the firing of the army. The Pak army launched indiscriminate attack and created havoc within the very month of March under the 'Operation Searchlight' having their post at the cantonment. The offices of the dailies like the Ittefaq, Sangbad and the Peoples were set on fire for their support to the movement of the Bangalis. A good number of journalists, media personnels were burnt to death.

7 TH MARCH SPEECH:

The 7 March Speech was a historic speech given by Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, the Founding Father of Bangladesh on 7 March 1971 at the Ramna Race Course (now

Suhrawardy Udyan) in Dhaka. In the speech, Bangabandhu informally declared independence of Bangladesh, proclaiming: "The struggle this time, is a struggle for our liberty. The struggle this time, is a struggle for our independence." \

He gave four pre-conditions in his speech:

1. Withdrawing martial law.
2. Handing over power to people's representatives.
3. Inquiries into mass killing by the army.
4. Taking the soldiers back to the barrack.

Background of 7th March Speech:

Pakistan was created in 1947, during the Partition of India, as a Muslim homeland in South Asia. Its territory comprised most of the Muslim-majority provinces of British India, including two geographically and culturally separate areas, one east of India and the other west. The western zone was popularly (and, for a period, officially) called West Pakistan; the eastern zone (modern-day Bangladesh) was called East Bengal and later renamed East Pakistan under the One Unit Scheme. West Pakistan dominated the country politically, and its leaders exploited the East economically, leading to popular grievances.

In 1966, the Awami League, led by Sheikh Mujib, launched the Six Point Movement to demand provincial autonomy for East Pakistan. The Pakistani establishment rejected the league's proposals, and the military government arrested Sheikh Mujib and charged him with treason in the Agartala Conspiracy Case. After three years in jail, Mujib was released in 1969, and the case against him was dropped in the face of mass protests and widespread violence in East Pakistan.

In 1970, the Awami League, the largest East Pakistani political party, won a landslide victory in national elections, winning 167 of the 169 seats allotted to East Pakistan and a majority of the 313 seats in the National Assembly. This gave it the constitutional right to form a government. However, Zulfikar Ali Bhutto, the leader of the Pakistan Peoples Party and a member of the Sindhi ethnic group, refused to allow Sheikh Mujib to become prime minister. Instead, he proposed having two prime ministers, one for each wing.

On 3 March, the convening of the National Assembly was postponed until 25 March, leading to an outcry across East Pakistan. Violence broke out in Dhaka, Chittagong,

Rangpur, Comilla, Rajshahi, Sylhet, and Khulna, and the security forces killed dozens of unarmed protesters. There were open calls for Sheikh Mujib to declare independence from Pakistan, and the Awami League called a large public gathering at Dhaka's Ramna Race Course on 7 March to respond.

Following is the full text of Sheikh Mujib's address to the nation delivered on the day before a mammoth gathering:

My dear brothers...

I have come before you today with a heavy heart. All of you know how hard we have tried. But it is a matter of sadness that the streets of Dhaka, Chittagong, Khulna, Rangpur and Rajshahi are today being spattered with the blood of my brothers, and the cry we hear from the Bengali people is a cry for freedom, a cry for survival, a cry for our rights.

You are the ones who brought about an Awami League victory so that you could see a constitutional government restored. The hope was that the elected representatives of the people, sitting in the National Assembly, would formulate a Constitution that would assure the people of their economic, political and cultural emancipation.

But now, with great sadness in my heart, I look back on the past 23 years of our history and see nothing but a history of the shedding of the blood of the Bangali people. Ours has been a history of continual lamentation, repeated bloodshed and incessant tears.

We gave blood in 1952, we won a mandate in 1954. But we were still not allowed to take up the reins of this country. In 1958, Ayub Khan clamped martial law on our people and enslaved us for the next 10 years. In 1966, during the Six-Point Movement of the masses, many were the young men and women whose lives were stilled by government bullets.

After the downfall of Ayub, Mr. Yahya Khan took over with the promise that he would restore constitutional rule, that he would restore democracy and return power to the people.

We agreed. But you all know of the events that took place after that...

I ask you, are we the ones to blame...

As you know, I have been in contact with President Yahya Khan. As leader of the majority party in the National Assembly, I asked him to set February 15 as the day

for its opening session. He did not accede to the request I made as leader of the majority party. Instead, he went along with the delay requested by the minority leader Mr. Bhutto and announced that the Assembly would be convened on the 3rd of March.

We accepted that, agreed to join the deliberations. I even went to the extent of saying that we, despite our majority, would still listen to any sound ideas from the minority, even if it was a lone voice. I committed myself to the support of anything to bolster the restoration of a constitutional government.

When Mr. Bhutto came to Dhaka, we met. We talked. He left, saying that the doors to negotiation were still open. Moulana Noorani and Moulana Mufti were among those West Pakistan parliamentarians who visited Dhaka and talked with me about an agreement on a constitutional framework.

I made it clear that we could not agree to any deviation from the Six Points. That right rested with the people. Come, I said, let us sit down and resolve matters.

But Bhutto's retort was that he would not allow himself to become hostage on two fronts. He predicted that if West Pakistani members of Parliament were to come to Dhaka, the Assembly would be turned into a slaughterhouse. He added that if anyone were to participate in such a session, a countrywide agitation would be launched from Peshawar to Karachi and that every business would be shut down in protest.

I assured him that the Assembly would be convened and, despite the dire threats, West Pakistani leaders did come down to Dhaka.

But suddenly, on March 1, the session was cancelled.

There was an immediate outcry against this move by the people. I called for a hartal as a peaceful form of protest and the masses readily took to the streets in response.

And what did we get as a response?

He turned his guns on my helpless people, a people with no arms to defend themselves. These were the same arms that had been purchased with our own money to protect us from external enemies. But it is my own people who are being fired upon today.

In the past, too, each time we, the numerically larger segment of Pakistan's population tried to assert our rights and control our destiny, they conspired against us and pounced upon us.

I have asked them before that how can you make your own brothers the target of your bullets?

Now Yahya Khan says that I had agreed to a Round Table Conference on the 10th. Let me point out that is not true.

I had said, Mr. Yahya Khan, you are the President of this country. Come to Dhaka, come and see how our poor Bangali people have been mown down by your bullets, how the laps of our mothers and sisters have been robbed and left empty and bereft, how my helpless people have been slaughtered. Come, I said, come and see for yourself and then be the judge and decide. That is what I told him...

Earlier, I had told him there would be no Round Table Conference. What Round Table Conference, whose Round Table Conference? How do you expect me to sit at a Round Table Conference with the very same people who have emptied the laps of my mothers and my sisters?

On the 3rd, at the Paltan, I called for a non-cooperation movement and the shutdown of offices, courts and revenue collection. You gave me full support. Then suddenly, without consulting me or even informing us, he met with one individual for five hours and then made a speech in which he turned all the blame on me, laid all the fault at the door of the Bangali people. The deadlock was created by Bhutto, yet the Bangalis are the ones facing the bullets! We face their guns, yet it's our fault. We are the ones being hit by their bullets, and it's still our fault! So, the struggle this time is a struggle for emancipation, the struggle this time is a struggle for independence!

Brothers, they have now called the Assembly to a session on March 25, with the streets not yet dry of the blood of my brothers. You have called the Assembly, but you must first agree to meet my demands. Martial law must be withdrawn; the soldiers must return to their barracks; the murder of my people must be redressed. And, power must be handed over to the elected representatives of the people. Only then will we consider if we can take part in the National Assembly or not. Before these demands are met, there can be no question of our participating in this session of the Assembly. That is the right that not given to me as part of my mandate from the masses.

As I told them earlier, Mujibur Rahman refuses to walk to the Assembly treading upon the fresh stains of his brothers' blood! Do you, my brothers, have complete faith in me...? ...

Let me then tell you that the Prime Ministership is not what I seek. What I want is justice, the rights of the people of this land. They tempted me with the Prime Ministership but they failed to buy me over. Nor did they succeed in hanging me on the gallows, for you rescued me with your blood from the so-called conspiracy case. That day, right here at this racecourse, I had pledged to you that I would pay for this blood debt with my own blood.

Do you remember? I am ready today to fulfil that promise! I now declare the closure of all the courts, offices, and educational institutions for an indefinite period of time. No one will report to their offices, that is my instruction to you. So that the poor are not inconvenienced, rickshaws, trains and other transport will ply normally except serving any needs of the armed forces. If the army does not respect this, I will not be responsible for the consequences.

The Secretariat, Supreme Court, High Court, Judges courts, and government and semi-government offices shall remain shut. Only banks may open for two hours daily for business transactions. But no money shall be transmitted from East to West Pakistan. The Bangali people must stay calm during these times. Telegraph and telephone communications will be confined within Bangladesh. The people of this land are facing elimination, so be on guard.

If need be, we will bring everything to a total standstill... Collect your salaries on time. If the salaries are held up, if a single bullet is fired upon us henceforth, if the murder of my people does not cease, I call upon you to turn every home into a fortress against their onslaught. Use whatever you can put your hands on to confront this enemy. Every last road must be blocked. We will deprive them of food, we will deprive them of water. Even if I am not around to give you the orders, and if my associates are also not to be found, I ask you to continue your movement unabated.

I say to them again, you are my brothers, return now to the barracks where you belong, and no one will bear any hostility toward you. Only do not attempt to aim any more bullets at our hearts: It will not do any good! ...

And the seven million people of this land will not be cowed down by you or accept suppression any more. The Bangali people have learnt how to die for a cause and you will not be able to bring them under your yoke of suppression!

To assist the families of the martyred and the injured, the Awami League has set up committees that will do all they can. Please donate whatever you can. Also, employers must give full pay to the workers who participated in the seven days of

hartal or were not able to work because of curfews. To all government employees, I say that my directives must be followed. I had better not see any of you attending your offices. From today, until this land has been freed, no taxes will be paid to the government any more.

As of now, they stop. Leave everything to me. I know how to organise a movement. But be very careful. Keep in mind that the enemy has infiltrated our ranks to engage in the work of provocateurs. Whether Bangali or nonBangali, Hindu or Muslim, all are our brothers, and it is our responsibility to ensure their safety. I also ask you to stop working in radio, television and the press if these media do not report news of our movement.

To them, I say, 'You are our brothers. I beseech you to not turn this country into a living hell. Will you not have to show your faces and confront your conscience some day? If we can peaceably settle our differences there is still hope that we can co-exist as brother. Otherwise there is no hope. If you choose the other path, we may never come face one another again. For now, I have just one thing to ask of you: Give up any thoughts of enslaving this country under military rule again!'

I ask my people to immediately set up committees under the leadership of the Awami League to carry on our struggle in every neighbourhood, village, union and subdivision of this land. You must prepare yourselves now with what little you have for the struggle ahead. Since we have given blood once, we will give more of it. But, Insha'Allah, we will free the people of this land!

The struggle this time is for emancipation! The struggle this time is for independence! Be ready. We cannot afford to lose our momentum. Keep the movement and the struggle alive because if we fall back they will come down hard upon us. Be disciplined. No nation's movement can be victorious without discipline. Jai Bangla! Jai Bangla!

The Importance of 7th March Speech

- ☐ This speech inspired all the people of the country to fight for liberation.
- ☐ This speech united the people and encouraged them to accept maximum sacrifice for the country.
- ☐ This speech magically transformed the Bangalee masses into a nation of Bangladesh heroes.
- ☐ The rule of Bangabandhu was established everywhere except in the cantonments.

- ❑ On 30 October, 2017 Unesco has recognised the historic 7th March Speech of Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman as a part of the world's documentary heritage.
- ❑ The 7 th March speech inspired the Bengalis to unite movement.
- ❑ It provides the direction of Guerrilla warfare.
- ❑ It plays an important role for the preparations of our independence war.
- ❑ It creates Bengali nationalism.
- ❑ It awakens democratic aspirations.
- ❑ Through his speech on 7 March, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman became one of the undisputed leaders of Bengal.

On 26 March 1971, Sheikh Mujibur Rahman declared independence on radio after, Pakistan launched a crackdown on East Pakistan called Operation Searchlight and declared martial law, which was heard by only a limited number of people due to the broadcasting system used.

Independence Day

The Independence Day of Bangladesh is celebrated on 26 March on the day Sheikh Mujibur Rahman declared the Independence of Bangladesh. Various programs are organized in the country to mark the occasion. The National Flag of Bangladesh is flown on all government buildings. The Independence Day Award was introduced by the Government of Bangladesh in 1977. The award is given on the Independence Day of Bangladesh on 26 March. The first Independence Day was celebrated on 26 March 1972.

MUJIBNAGAR GOVERNMENT:

The Provisional Government of the People's Republic of Bangladesh, popularly known as the Mujibnagar Government, was established following the declaration of independence of East Pakistan on 10 April 1971. It was the supreme leadership of the Bangladeshi liberation movement.

As the Pakistan military force started genocide on 25 March of 1971, the people of East Pakistan posed resistance against them initially without any preparation and organizational movement. In order to administer the liberation war efficiently the first provisional government of Bangladesh was formed on 10 April. The formal swearing in ceremony was held on 17 April at Vaidynathtala in Meherpur district. A large number of local and foreign journalists and other dignitaries was attended in this ceremony. This government was headed by Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman. The village Vaidynathtala was named Mujibnagar after his name and the provisional government also came to be popularly termed as Mujibnagar government. However, the aircraft of Pakistan Air Force bombed at Mujibnagar and took control of it just after two hours of formation of this government. Hence, the headquarters of Mujibnagar government was shifted to 8 Theatre Road in Kolkata.

The Mujibnagar Government:

- President: Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman
- Vice President: Syed Nazrul Islam (the Acting President, in absence of Bangabandhu)
- Prime Minister: Tajuddin Ahmed
- Finance Minister: M. Masur Ali
- Home, Agriculture, relief and Rehabilitation Minister: A. H. M. Kamruzzaman
- Foreign, Law and Parliamentary Affairs Minister: Khondokar Moshtaq Ahmed
- Commander in Chief: Colonel (Rtd.) M. A. G. Osmani
- Chief of Staff: Lt. Colonel (Rtd.) Abdur Rob
- Deputy Chief of Staff: Group Captain A. K. Khondokar

Mujibnagar government was divided into fifteen ministries and divisions. Besides, some divisions were placed under the Cabinet. The functions of the ministries and divisions were-

Vice President, Prime Minister, Ministers and Commander-in-Chief Incharge of Mujibnagar Government

Ministry of Defence Staff MAG Osmany, Commander-in-Chief; SA Samad, Defence Secretary; Colonel Abdur Rab, Chief of Staff. The Ministry of Defence divided the war zone into eleven sectors and appointed a sector commander for each of the sectors. But there was no sector commander for sector No 10 or naval sector. Commandos used to fight under the command of the concerned sector commander whenever and wherever they carried out the operation in a particular sector. Besides, there were three brigades called Z force, K force and S force. Major Ziaur Rahman, Major Khaled Mosharraf and Major Km Shafiullah were the commanders of the brigades respectively.

Ministry of Foreign Affairs sought to obtain support of the foreign governments and people at large for the cause of liberation of Bangladesh by establishing Bangladesh mission abroad and by sending diplomatic emissaries to various countries. With this end in view diplomatic missions were established in Kolkata, Delhi, London, Washington, New York, and Stockholm. Diplomatic delegations were sent to the UNO, Afghanistan, Syria, Lebanon, Nepal, Srilanka, Burma, Thailand and Japan for gaining their support to the liberation war.

Ministry of Finance, Industry and Commerce was headed by M Mansur Ali and Khondaker Asaduzzaman was its secretary.

Cabinet Secretariat placed various proposals about the operation of the liberation war to the cabinet meeting, implementation of the decisions of the meeting, and monitoring and recording these decisions. HT Imam was the secretary of the ministry.

General Administration Division was formed under the Ministry of Establishment to deal with appointment, transfer, promotion and framing of service rules. Nurul Qader was the secretary of the Establishment Division.

Zonal Administrative Council was formed under General Administration Division. Nine administrative zones with a chairman for each were formed to look after

administration of lubrication war activities. Each zone had a headquarters, and a chairman.

Ministry of Health and Welfare worked under a Director General. Later the position of the Director General was elevated to the status of a secretary. The functions of the health department was divided into two sectors: a) to impart medical treatment to the freedom fighters under the army ie under the Ministry of Defence and b) to render medical treatment to such civilians or persons who did not participate in the liberation war directly with arms.

Ministry of Information and Broadcasting played important role to build up public opinion in favour of the liberation war. This ministry used to perform its functions through four divisions: a) Radio (swadhin bangla betar kendra), b) Films, c) Publications, d) Fine arts and design.

Ministry of Home was responsible for maintaining law and order in the liberated areas. This ministry selected the uniform, badge and monogram of the Bangladesh police force. Abdul Khaleque was made the first IG of the police and was later appointed as home secretary.

Relief and Rehabilitation Division was created under the supervision of the Ministry of Home and Ministry of Relief with a view to rehabilitate the refugees taking shelter in India.

Parliamentary Affairs Division worked under the ministries of Foreign Affairs and Law and Parliamentary Affairs. The main task of this division was to solve various problems of the members of Provincial and National Assembly and to engage them in various activities.

Agriculture Division worked for finding ways and means for taking measures to overcome food crisis by increasing food production in the post-war Bangladesh, introducing scientific cultivation and providing loans to farmers under easy terms in view of the wartime losses.

Role of Mujibnagar government in our Liberation War-

- The Mujibnagar government united the scattered and isolated Bengali nation in different parts of Bengal during the liberation war.

- From 1947-1971, the Pakistani ruling class repeatedly bowed to the student movement. So the Mujibnagar government united the student society to conduct the war of liberation properly.
- The Mujibnagar government set up training centers and provided training in different parts of Bengal during the liberation war.
- Divided Bangladesh into 11 sectors to led the war.
- During the War of Liberation, the Mujibnagar government established diplomatic relations with the outside world by sending delegates to various countries including India, United States, United Kingdom, France and Soviet Union.
- Creates public opinion in favor of liberation war.
- Conducts media during the war of liberation.
- Conducts civilian activities

More Info. About Mujibnagar government-
https://en.banglapedia.org/index.php/Mujibnagar_Government

LIBERATION WAR

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Bangladesh_Liberation_War

https://en.banglapedia.org/index.php/War_of_Liberation,_The

Learn more information about liberation movement.

